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# NIGERIAN ARMY TRADITIONS CUSTOMS AND ETHICS 2025

Prepared under the direction of

**OO OLUYEDE** NAM CMH GSS psc mini FCM FCMH TSM GOM CCA  
Lieutenant General  
Chief of Army Staff

Abuja  
May 2025

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# **AND ETHICS**

## **2025**

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**OO OLUYEDE** NAM CMH GSS psc mni FCM FCMH TSM CCA  
Lieutenant General  
Chief of Army Staff

Abuja  
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i

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## **FOREWORD**

Traditions Customs and Ethics (TCEs) are the core values, practices and principles of behaviour that define and identify the Nigerian Army (NA) as a professional fighting force. Over the years, TCEs have served the purpose of giving the NA a sense of identity. TCEs have also played a pivotal role in fostering pride in the men and women of the NA while engendering the competence and commitment necessary for the successful conduct of operations. The TCEs of the NA have over time been shaped by the experiences of personnel in and out of combat. TCEs have also been influenced by technological developments and advancements in society. These factors have made it pertinent to periodically review TCEs in the NA to keep pace with current trends and realities, in line with global best practices.

On this premise, the 2005 version of the TCEs was reviewed and the 2023 edition of the document was formulated. The 2023 edition provides the requisite guidelines for personnel to exhibit military professionalism and other invaluable qualities that demonstrate the status of the NA as a resolute fighting force. As the NA continues to prevail amidst the challenges of the dynamic and complex operational environment, it is incumbent upon commanders and leaders at all levels to educate personnel on the contents of the document. I therefore recommend all personnel to acquaint themselves with the provisions of the document as the essential basis for military professionalism in the NA. I also urge all personnel to strive to emulate the provisions of the document and model it in their day to day actions and endeavours.



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May 2025

iii  
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## **PREFACE**

Since its inception, the Nigerian Army (NA) has embraced Traditions, Customs and Ethics (TCEs) that convey its prowess as a professional military force. These TCEs provide a connection to the history and heritage of the NA while conveying the richness of the experiences of its officers and men. As the NA transforms to confront the complexities of the future operational environment, it is necessary to update the TCEs to reflect current trends and realities. On this premise, the 2005 edition of the TCEs was reviewed and the 2023 version was formulated.

The 2023 edition of the document contains an update of the core values, traditions and customs as well as ethics of the NA in line with current practices across formations and units. The document also contains a revision of some provisions of the TCEs to reflect contemporary trends. Notable are the revision of the provisions on Quarter Guard, Guard of Honour and Regimental Guard Mounting among others. Some modifications were also made to the TCEs, such as amendment of the procedures for some parades, inclusion of some new military activities as well as review of the definition of some key terms. The booklet is therefore expected to serve as the principal reference material to guide personnel on the practices and behaviours to be upheld to ensure professionalism in the NA. I therefore encourage all personnel to acquaint themselves with the contents of the booklet and imbibe its provisions in the day to day performance of their duties.

**LA FEJOKWU**

Major General

Chief of Administration (Army)

Abuja

May 2025

**TABLE OF CONTENTS**

|                       |     |
|-----------------------|-----|
| Condition for Release | ii  |
| Foreword              | iii |
| Preface               | iv  |
| Table of Contents     | v   |

**Section 1**

|                                     |   |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| Introduction                        | 1 |
| Definition of Terms                 | 2 |
| Relevance of Customs and Traditions | 7 |

**Section 2**

|                             |    |
|-----------------------------|----|
| The Core Values of the NA   | 9  |
| The Core Values             | 9  |
| Maintaining the Core Values | 13 |

**Section 3**

|                                     |    |
|-------------------------------------|----|
| Traditions and Customs of the NA    | 14 |
| Drills                              | 14 |
| Parades                             | 16 |
| Ceremonies                          | 26 |
| Messes                              | 36 |
| Colours Flags Portraits and Mascots | 42 |
| Salute                              | 52 |

## RESTRICTED

|                              |    |
|------------------------------|----|
| Etiquette                    | 54 |
| Courtesies                   | 54 |
| Starting the Military Career | 55 |
| Orientation Cadre            | 55 |
| Regimental Activities        | 56 |
| Bugle Calls                  | 56 |
| Indigenous Songs             | 58 |
| Duty Officer                 | 58 |
| Honours and Awards           | 60 |
| Dress, Uniform and Insignia  | 61 |
| Miscellaneous Decorum        | 65 |

### Section 4

|                                                                      |    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Ethics                                                               | 75 |
| Ethics in Relation to Status as a Citizen<br>and Government Employee | 75 |
| Ethics in Relation to the Military Profession                        | 82 |
| War Ethics                                                           | 96 |
| Code of Conduct                                                      | 98 |

### Section 5

|                                   |     |
|-----------------------------------|-----|
| Summary Code of Ethics for the NA | 105 |
|-----------------------------------|-----|

RESTRICTED

## SECTION 1

### INTRODUCTION

1. The military in any nation is saddled with the distinctive responsibility of defending the citizens as well as landmass from aggression. It also remains a vital instrument in the hands of the political leadership for the pursuit of the nation's strategic interest. In fulfillment of this noble role, the military in general and the army in particular, have fought wars both at home and in distant lands. The destructive and risky nature of war has conferred on the profession of arms a character of its own that lays premium on an exacting standard and nobility. This has given rise to a military culture that emphasizes hierarchy, discipline, loyalty and regimentation among others. These common military virtues when conditioned by experiences and societal values gives the military in each nation its distinct character as enshrined in its traditions, customs and ethics.

2. The Nigerian Army (NA) inherited rich customs and traditions as well as a noble code of ethics from its British heritage. These customs, traditions and the code of ethics were used by the colonialist to turn slaves, outlaws, stragglers and conscripts into a disciplined and effective constabulary. The Nigerian Regiment which metamorphosed from the colonial Hausa Constabulary was later to prove her mettle with victories in Abyssinia and Mogadishu during the Second World War. These victories and the recognition that came with them provided a foundation of pride and confidence for the NA when Nigeria became independent. It is largely accepted that the NA took off as a small, compact, disciplined, well organized and highly motivated force.

3. To build on the enviable ethical foundation the NA inherited, it is essential that its traditions, customs and ethical



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values are constantly enriched with lessons from its wide operational engagements. The norms of the larger society and developments in the global scene, including strides in technology, must also be brought to bear. This becomes necessary because no societal organization can exist in isolation. Peculiar as the military profession might appear, the army is a product of society. Therefore to remain relevant to the Nigerian public, the NA must not only draw inspiration from our national values, but the officers and soldiers must at all times represent all that is best of our national character.

4. This review of the Traditions, Customs and Ethics of the NA is aimed at updating the document which was compiled in 1997. The traditions, customs and ethics that are set out in this document are vital to sustaining the trust and cohesion with which the NA has served this nation. They are also essential for the NA's future roles at home and abroad. Inculcating and maintaining these ethical standards is a core responsibility of commanders at all levels. Training institutions also have an important role to play in this respect as they are required to provide foundation lectures and instructions on this important aspect of the military career.

5. In the light of the above, all are enjoined to give this document a wide circulation and readership to ensure that the core values, which form the spirit behind the traditions, customs and ethics that have given the Army a pride of place, are continuously kept alive. The purpose of this document, therefore, is to lay down the acceptable standards of conduct expected of those who serve in the NA.

## **DEFINITION OF TERMS**

6. Some of the terms and concepts used in this compilation are defined below:

a. **Culture**. Culture is the way of life of a people. It includes the customs, ideas and values of a group which are either written or unwritten.

b. **Traditions**. Traditions are customary patterns of thoughts, actions or behaviours that are identifiable with a group of people. They include information, beliefs and customs that are handed down by word of mouth or by example from one generation to another with or without written instructions.

c. **Ethics**. Ethics are rules or principles of behaviour for persons, groups or communities which are sometimes written down to be observed. Ethics have to do with a person's conscience to judge between what is right or wrong.

d. **Ethos**. Ethos are the typical spirit, character or attitude of a group of people. The ethos of the NA inspire the soldier to do his best in any given circumstance. Adherence to ethos motivates and enhances morale. Ethos may be translated into slogans such as "Yield to Nothing".

e. **Customs**. Customs are the established practices of a community or group and may be written or unwritten. The NA has customs that guide official and social conduct. Some customs are handed down from the distant past while others are of comparatively recent origin. As a long established social organization, the NA observes a number of customs that add beauty to life in or outside the barracks.

f. **Etiquettes**. Etiquettes are conventions of correct or polite social behaviour among a group of people.

g. **Courtesies**. Courtesies involve good manners and politeness in dealing with others including respect for one another. Courtesies are reciprocated from the bottom to the top and vice versa. Military courtesies have been developed and observed in the NA and have become an integral part of the Service.

h. **Taboos**. Taboos are practices or conducts forbidden among a group of people or organization.

i. **Moral**. Moral relates to the principles of good or bad, right or wrong. It is a way of confirming what is good, right, proper or ethical by the society or an organization.

j. **Values**. Values are moral principles and standards that guide an organization, community or group.

k. **Security Breach**. Security breach is an act of commission or omission that may jeopardize national security.

l. **Order**. An order is a command, directive or instruction given by somebody in authority. It can be lawful or unlawful.

m. **Lawful Order**. A lawful order is an order which is legal and in accordance with military and civil laws of Nigeria as well as the Laws of Armed Conflict. The acid test for ascertaining a lawful order is that the order must not be tainted with any form of illegality.

n. **Unlawful Order**. An unlawful order is an order which is illegal and against either the military and civil laws of Nigeria or the Laws of Armed Conflict.

o. **Lawful Duty**. A lawful duty is any task, assignment or action which an officer or soldier must perform. It must be legal and not tainted with any form of illegality.

p. **Illegal Duty**. An illegal duty is a task, assignment or action which is contrary to either military or civil laws of Nigeria or the Laws of Armed Conflict.

q. **Military Duty**. Military duty is any lawful task or assignment given to an officer or soldier by his superior towards the accomplishment of the mission of the unit or establishment.

r. **Official Duty**. Official duty is any lawful task or assignment given to an officer or soldier by his superior. In this case, the superior officer must by virtue of his office, be vested with authority which he can exercise over the officer or soldier as a subordinate. Official duty includes military duty.

s. **Officer**. An officer is a person who is selected, trained and granted a Presidential Commission into the NA. On commission, he takes an Oath of Allegiance to the C-in-C and the Federal Republic of Nigeria. At any rank, the officer is a leader and therefore must be exemplary in courage, conduct and proficiency. Besides his personal attributes, he must be knowledgeable in his field of specialization. This will place him on a high pedestal to exercise leadership and mould his subordinates into competent, disciplined and motivated team. The officer's value does not lie in his personal competence alone but in his capacity to understand his group and harness the competencies of individual members to provide unmatched group competence.

t. **Soldier**. A soldier is a person who is recruited, trained and takes an Oath of Attestation. In his oath, the soldier pledges to obey the C-in-C and the officers appointed over him. The soldier shares the same bond with the officer to defend the country against aggressors even when it means making the supreme sacrifice. This is displayed in an unwavering commitment to doing the best and not quitting until assigned missions have been accomplished. Each soldier has an important job to do towards the accomplishment of the unit mission. However, the biggest strength of the soldier is realized when his personal commitment is converted to collective commitment. This makes the individual soldier the most important resource of the NA even in an age of sophisticated equipment and weaponry. The term soldier may be used in the generic sense to refer to commissioned officers, warrant officers, non-commissioned officers and privates collectively.

u. **Officer Cadet**. Officer Cadet is the status assumed by a soldier/rating/airman/civilian while undergoing training for a commission.

v. **Recruit**. A recruit is a person who is undergoing training and on completion is enlisted into the NA.

w. **Formation/Unit Mascots**. Mascots are objects, animals or persons that are chosen as a symbol of a regiment and are assumed to bring good luck. Mascots, especially tamed animals, may be brought to the parade ground during ceremonial parade involving the regiment. All battalions/regiments are expected to have their own mascots which must be approved by AHQ and Army Number allotted to them for payment of personal emoluments.

**RELEVANCE OF CUSTOMS AND TRADITIONS**

7. Land operations which are the mandate of the NA are by their nature dangerous and physically demanding. They are characterized by uncertainty, fear, fatigue and discomfort, all of which have to be faced and overcome. Ultimately, they require soldiers to close up with the enemy at short range, often face to face, and fight and to continue operating while subject to life-threatening attack by conventional or unconventional means. The other fundamental characteristic of land operations is that they are a group activity, whether the task is full scale war, peace support operation, or activity in support of civil authority. Even when deployed on their own in dispersed positions, soldiers are part of a team. The effectiveness of the team will depend on each individual playing his part to the full, and upon the degree to which they contribute to the cohesion of the team as a whole. Success in such conditions depends to a large extent on good morale, which is the spirit that enables soldiers to triumph over adversity.

8. Morale derives from many factors, including confidence in equipment, good training and sound administration. Ultimately morale is bred on conviction in what is being done and confidence in those with whom and for whom it is being done. Such confidence is itself primarily a product of leadership and comradeship. High morale cannot be inculcated overnight. It requires the forging of close bonds of professional and personal trust during peacetime which will withstand the stress imposed by operational conditions. Furthermore, to entrench high morale, soldiers are required to show commitment and self-sacrifice by putting the interest of the team, the task, the unit and the nation above personal interest. The forging of professional bond, personal trust, and consequently, high morale is best achieved through upholding and sustaining cherished traditions, customs

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and ethics. It is on the manure of these rich traditions of the NA that essential qualities for military services can germinate and be nourished.

**SECTION 2**

**THE CORE VALUES OF THE NA**

9. The core values of the NA are those values which compel the soldier to fulfill his obligations to the Army with respect and honour. There is every possibility of fulfilling these obligations by accepting and living with these values. These core values include loyalty, selfless service, courage, discipline, integrity and respect for others. They require from the soldier, commitment, self-sacrifice and mutual trust and the will to put the interest of the team, the task, the unit and the Nation ahead of their own.

**THE CORE VALUES**

10. **Loyalty**. The Nation, the NA and the chain of command rely on the continuing allegiance, commitment and support of all who serve. Those who are placed in positions of authority must be loyal to their subordinates, representing their interests faithfully, dealing with complaints thoroughly, and developing their abilities through progressive training. For their part, subordinates must be loyal to the Service, their leaders, their group and be committed to their duty. Such loyalty is expected, but it must also be earned through self-sacrifice, courage, professionalism, decency and integrity. Loyalty to the NA requires all ranks to foster and adhere to these qualities at all times, off duty as well as on duty. Personnel who behave badly when off duty not only let themselves down by their lack of self-discipline, but are being disloyal – they damage respect for the NA, their unit, and for other soldiers who may well suffer as a result.

11. **Selfless Service**. On joining the NA, soldiers accept an open-ended commitment to serve whenever and wherever they



are needed, whatever the difficulties or dangers may be. This commitment is reflected in the oath which is taken on commission or attestation, in which they agree to subordinate their own interests to their units, the NA and the Nation. It imposes a degree of limitations on individual freedom. This may involve long periods of separation from family and friends, disruption caused by short notice to move and the carrying out of regimental guards and duties. Ultimately, it may involve laying down of the soldier's life. For the leaders, it requires them to fully discharge their responsibilities and duty of care to subordinates, whether in war or peacetime. This 2 way obligation forms a covenant between the NA and its soldiers. Both share a common bond of identity, loyalty and responsibility to each other which is mostly unwritten but unbreakable. This bond has been the mainstay of the NA. Officers and soldiers accept that, by putting the needs of the Service before their own, they will forgo some of the rights enjoyed by those outside the military. But in return they can at all times expect fair treatment, to be valued, respected as individuals and to be rewarded by reasonable Terms and Conditions of Service. By extension, this covenant also exists between the NA and the Nation it serves.

12. **Courage.** All soldiers must prepare for tasks that include the use of controlled lethal force to fight. They may be required to take the lives of others, and knowingly to risk their own. They are also required to show restraint, even when such involves personal danger. They may witness death or injury to their comrades but still continue with the task at hand. All these require physical courage. Moral courage which is the courage to do what is right even when it may be unpopular, or involve the risk of ridicule or danger is equally important. Soldiers must insist on maintaining the highest standards of decency in conduct and behaviour at all times and under all circumstances. This will foster trust among them and earn them respect from one another.

Fighting spirit and success depend on both physical and moral courage. Though all soldiers need courage, it is especially important for those in position of authority and leadership because others will depend on them.

13. **Discipline**. Discipline is an attitude centered on respect for constituted authority and is developed by leadership, precepts and training. It is a state of mind which leads to the willingness to obey an order no matter how unpleasant or dangerous the task to be performed. Discipline markedly differentiates the soldier and is absolutely essential in the armed forces. The NA is hierarchical and structured in a way that it places responsibility of custody and maintenance of laws and orders on the officers, warrant officers and non-commissioned officers. It is the duty of superiors to notice, correct and instantly report any negligence or inappropriate conduct on the part of subordinates. In the event of any breach, it is expected that appropriate disciplinary measure must be taken by commanders to forestall future occurrence. It means that there must be clearly laid down rules and regulations while the legal system must be fair and just to be effective. Discipline must be vigorously upheld by those in position of authority. However, the best discipline the NA expects is self-discipline which is the hallmark of commitment, loyalty and readiness to put the interest of the Service ahead of self-interest.

14. **Integrity**. Integrity is an essential ingredient of trust and a core requirement for leadership and comradeship. All forms of deceit and dishonesty or breaches of trust or confidence call into question whether an individual can be relied upon. For example, if a soldier is known to be selfish or dishonest, trust between him and his comrades will be damaged and tensions created within the group which will reduce its effectiveness. This is also true of those who misuse public fund, or make fraudulent claims. Integrity demands that those who are in positions of authority, at

whatever level, are fair and consistent at all times to their subordinates. Only then will they earn the respect and loyalty that are essential to leadership.

15. **Respect for Others**. The responsibility of bearing arms and using lethal force makes it vital that all soldiers act properly under the law. They need to maintain the highest standards of discipline and a sense of justice at all times to all people even in the face of danger and difficulties. The need for discipline, compassion, fairness and respect for others is increased by the conditions in which soldiers may have to live and operate. They will often have no choice of the company they keep and may have no relief from it for extended periods. The condition in which they have to co-exist may be cramped, uncomfortable and stressful. In such circumstances, respect for others is very important. Commanders must be quite clear that they have a continuous responsibility for the wellbeing of their subordinates and that any disregard or abuse of that responsibility amounts to neglect.

## **MAINTAINING THE CORE VALUES**

16. Maintaining the core values which have been discussed underpins the ethos of the NA and so contributes directly to the sustenance of its fighting spirit. In order to sustain these values, every officer and soldier must strive to achieve and maintain the highest professional standards, thereby enhancing both the competence and cohesion of the group. Therefore, the Core Values of the NA have become imperative and expedient for all Service personnel to imbibe. Soldiers must have conviction in what they are doing and confidence in those with whom and for whom they are working. Leadership is the ability to influence and motivate followers, to imbue them with trust and confidence so that they will carry out assigned mission confidently and to their best ability. Leaders achieve this by demonstrating sound knowledge as well as abilities such as being able to communicate with followers. Good leaders lead by example and do so to achieve mission command. The optimal performance of formations and units and other NA establishments can only be assured by persons who are competent to lead, and inspire others to give their best at all times.

## SECTION 3

### TRADITIONS AND CUSTOMS OF THE NA

17. Military traditions and customs are interesting, rich and often amusing to the outsiders. Those of the NA are not exceptions. They give our soldiers a feeling of pride to understand just why things are done in peculiar ways. NA traditions and customs are common patterns of behaviour, actions and the responses expected in a given situation within the Service while unit traditions and customs are unique to particular units. Some of these are discussed in subsequent paragraphs.

### DRILLS

*“Maintain discipline and caution above all things, and be on the alert to obey the word of command. It is both the noblest and the safest thing for a great army to be visibly animated by one spirit. “*

***Archidamus of Sparta: To the Lacaedaemonian expeditionary force departing for Athens, 431 B.C.***

18. Drill is the basic foundation of military regimentation. It is the yardstick for measuring the level of discipline of a force and the building block that sharpens the individual soldier's military career. Drill is aimed at producing a soldier who is proud, alert and obedient. It also provides the basis for teamwork. The various drills taught and practised in the NA are described under succeeding headings.

19. **Foot Drills.** Foot drills are individual and collective drills carried out at a halt or on the march without the use of arms or swords. It is the foundation of all other drills. As it is commonly

said “one with a poor personal foot drill will bring down the level of our collective squad drill”. Foot drills are to be practiced at platoon and company levels to improve standards and foster esprit de corps in the regiment.

20. **Squad Drills.** Squad drills in the NA are carried out on the move in quick or slow time. The squad has 2 prescribed formations, line and column, either in twos or threes. The movement of troops in these formations forms the basis of all parades and ceremonial drills. Squad drill is first taught in slow and then in quick time. Squad drills provide the rudiments for teamwork in the NA and should be rehearsed always at platoon and company levels.

21. **Arms Drills.** Arms drills refer to drills carried out with weapons which are incorporated into ceremonial parades. The use of weapons on parade dates back to the evolution of warfare and it is aimed at showcasing the lethality of a force and expertise in the use of its weapons. In today's armies, the weapons carried on parade are ceremonial and do not bear ammunition except blank ammunition on special occasions such as funeral ceremonies. Nonetheless, they form a fundamental part of the parades. Before teaching arms drill as contained in NA Drill (All Arms) 1974, troops should be proficient in foot and squad drills.

22. **Sword Drills.** Sword drills are taught to officers who bear and use swords on parade. Although warrant officers carry swords on parades, they do not draw them except during Trooping and Presentation of Colour Parade. Two qualities that should be pursued in sword drill are accuracy and graceful movement. All NA officers are to ensure that they practice and perfect the movements in sword drills.

23. **Cane and Stick Drills.** Cane and stick drills involve the

use of cane and the pace stick usually carried by RSM/CSM. It is often required to appoint soldiers as cane/stick orderlies to reviewing/visiting officers during ceremonial parades. These orderlies act as guides to the reviewing officer. The pace stick drill is mainly meant for SNCOs and drill instructors that are required to bear the sticks. The details of the procedure for stick/cane drills are contained in NA Drill (All Arms) 1974 Chapter 12.

24. **Sentry Drills.** Sentry drills are carried out by sentries to enable them pay compliments, challenge intruders, turn out the guard and patrol while at their sentry posts. The drills are intended to ensure that the sentries remain at alert throughout the duration of their duty. Procedures for sentry drills are contained in NA Drill (All Arms) 1974.

25. **Mounted Drills.** Mounted drills are conducted with an officer on a horse. It is a well-known custom for army officers to ride on horseback especially officers of Guards Brigade, Adjutants of the NDA and officers of Depot NA during ceremonial parades. Officers are to develop interest in horse riding to sustain regimentation. Procedures for mounted drill are as contained in NA Drill (All Arms) 1974 and Ceremonial for the Army 1968, Chapter 4 Section 2.

26. **Silent Drill.** Silent drill is a unique precision and exhibition drill where troops perform marching sequences without words of command. Silent drills may involve complex marching sequences that deviate from the sequences adopted in the course of other conventional parades and drills.

## **PARADES**

*“They [soldiers] must learn to keep their ranks, to obey words of command, and signals by drum and trumpet, and to observe*

*good order; whether they halt, advance, retreat, are upon a march, or engage with an enemy.”*

### **Niccolo Machiavelli Arte della Guerra, 1520**

27. **Military Parades**. Military parades are an extension of drill. They are aimed at showcasing the level of discipline, expertise and strength of a regiment or unit. The various parades in the NA are discussed in the subsequent paragraphs.

28. **Réveille**. Réveille is the first bugle call sounded in the early hours of the morning at exactly 0600 hours. It is meant to signify the commencement of the day's activities in a military barracks. The parade entails turning out the Quarter Guard by the Quarter Guard Sergeant, hosting of the National Flag by the Duty RP while the bugle is sounded. All ranks within earshot are to halt and face the direction of the flag while Officers and Warrant Officers in uniform are to salute. It is important in a military barracks' daily routine as it instils time consciousness in the officers and soldiers. Deliberate efforts must be made by all NA formations and units to train buglers so as to sustain the practice of this important army tradition.

29. **Retreat**. The term Retreat is taken from the French word 'Retraite' and refers to the evening ceremony. The bugle call sounded retreat was first used in the French Army and dates back to the era of the Crusades. Retreat is sounded at sunset to notify sentries to start challenging intruders until sunrise, and to tell all troops to move back to their quarters or leave the centre of fighting. The ceremony which remains as a tradition today is also applicable to the NA. The parade involves the turning out of the Quarter Guard and the sounding of the bugle while the National Flag is being lowered. All troops within earshot are expected to halt and face the direction of the flag while Officers and Warrant Officers in uniform are to salute.



30. **Tattoo**. Tattoo is an out-door military show with the use of the bugle at night to check men on daily basis after the day's work. Originally, this word was rendered in English as 'tap toe' or 'tap too'. The commonly accepted origin of the military version is from the practice of Seventeenth Century Armies of Provost Marshalls visiting the civilian inns and taverns at night, informing the proprietors when it was time for the troops to return to Garrison to 'tap the bungs into the barrels' as it were. Eventually, the custom gave way to a party of drummers parading the garrison at the same time, each night, beating a signal to inform soldiers that it was time for them to return to quarters. This gave rise to colourful musical ceremony such as the 'Edinburgh Tattoo'. In the NA, once in a while, officers and soldiers may be treated to tattoo musical show. At unit level, the event is used to check the men on daily basis after the day's work. This is to ensure that all personnel are back and complete in the barracks. It helps commanders at all levels to account for their men. Immediately after tattoo the signal for lights out are to be given. The timing for tattoo will depend on the exigency of duty for the unit, though it is expected that by 2300 hours, all unit activities should have ended.

31. **Quarter Guards**. Quarter guards are mounted by units and formations to showcase the discipline, alertness and readiness of the unit. They are inspected by unit commanders on a daily or weekly basis as may be convenient and also by visiting commandants of military institutions, formation commanders, Corps Commanders and equivalents, Service Chiefs or their representatives. It could also be inspected by deserving members of the 3 arms of Government, members of the diplomatic community and heads of security agencies. The Quarter Guard will consist of 9 soldiers, a sergeant as guard commander, a corporal or lance corporal as second in command, 6 privates and a bugler. The RSM will be positioned centrally at the rear of the

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quarter guard. During the inspection, the best turned out soldier among the privates is selected as the stick orderly to the Commander/Commanding Officer for the day. His duties will be as follows:

- a. He will report to the Adjutant when his guard has taken over.
- b. He will wear full ceremonial dress, and the regalia of his office.
- c. He will be attendant to the Commander/Commanding Officer throughout the tour of duty of his guard.
- d. He will accompany the Commander/Commanding Officer wherever he goes unless specifically ordered not to do so.
- e. When not attending to the Commander/Commanding Officer, he will remain outside the Commander/Commanding Officer's office and will not go away without permission of the Adjutant.

32. **Change of Quarter Guard.** Change of quarter guard parade is mounted weekly in a regiment to signify the end of duty for a Quarter Guard. The parade entails the turning out of the Old Quarter Guard and the replacement by the New Quarter Guard. This parade is conducted under the supervision of the Unit Adjutant. The 2 guard commanders will report to the Adjutant and take permission to march off the guards. For procedure, please see NA pamphlet entitled Ceremonial for the Army 1975.

33. **Change of Guard.** Change of Guard Parade is a ceremonial parade which is conducted at the State House and the

National Cenotaph to signify the changing of the old set of guards with a new one. The parade entails the old guard formed up facing the new guard with the old and new quarter guards, as well as the National and Regimental Colours on parade. The old and new guard commanders march off to signify their moving to the office to sign the handing and taking over notes and while this is done, the Colours patrol between the 2 guards. At the same time the old Quarter Guard hands over to the new one. This parade is conducted on a weekly basis by troops from the Guards Brigade and could also be conducted on special occasions.

34. **Guard of Honour**. Guard of Honour parade is mounted for important dignitaries visiting a country, unit or formation. The 2 types of Guard of Honour are Full and Half Guard of Honour. When authorised, a Full Guard of Honour consists of 5 officers and 96 soldiers with a major or captain in command. Two officers of the rank of Subaltern are ensigns to the National and Regimental Colours while the 2 sub guard commanders are also subalterns. One company sergeant major, 3 colour sergeants and 2 sergeants may be mounted, with the regimental band in attendance. This parade is mounted for visiting presidents, heads of state and governments, foreign sovereigns, and state governors. Half Guard of Honour not exceeding 5 officers and 48 soldiers with a captain as the commander, 2 officers as ensigns to the National and Regimental Colours respectively and sub guard commanders and a regimental band may be mounted for the following dignitaries:

- a. Foreign diplomats accredited to the Federal Republic of Nigeria during presentation of Letters of Credence.
- b. Visiting Chiefs of Defence Staff, Service Chiefs and Commanders of United Nations, African Union as well as Sub-Regional Peacekeeping Forces.

- c Chief of Defence Staff.
- d Chief of Army Staff on his first official or farewell visit to a formation.
- e Other Service Chiefs.
- f General Officers Commanding, on assumption of command and when relinquishing command.
- g A Commonwealth or foreign general, Flag or Air Officer Commanding visiting a military formation.
- h Distinguished dignitaries other than those mentioned in Paragraphs 33 a – g may be considered expedient.

**35. Regimental Guard Mounting.** Regimental Guard Mounting is one of the unit daily routine activities. All guards mounted by a regiment reflect its state of alertness, turnout, discipline and military bearing. These parades are mounted to ensure that all troops for guard duties are complete and ready for duty. The regimental guard mounting is supervised by the Duty Officer who may use the opportunity to pass instructions to the guards. They are an important means by which the level of preparedness of a unit can be assessed. It is the duty of all ranks to exert their best behaviour in all matters pertaining to the Regimental Guard Mounting Parade. The parade is mounted twice daily, in the morning and evening as appropriate at the unit parade ground. Furthermore, units deployed in theatres of operation may not have to conduct the Regimental Guard Mounting daily. It therefore behoves the unit commander to use his discretion depending on the level of threat in his AOR as well as the commitment of the unit.

36. **RSM Parade.** RSM parade is more or less a rehearsal for the Commanding Officer and Adjutant's parades. It is usually conducted weekly on Mondays or as otherwise directed in the unit. The RSM uses this parade to infuse the newly posted recruits into the unit before presenting them for the Commanding Officer's parade.

37. **Adjutant's Parade.** Adjutant's parade is a regimental parade in which all officers subordinate to the Adjutant participate. It is usually conducted on a monthly basis or as otherwise directed in the unit. The sequence is contained in the Ceremonial for the Army 1975.

38. **Investiture Parades/Ceremonies.** All investiture parades for customary and proficiency awards must be carried out in line with NA Schedule of Activities. These parades/ceremonies (even for only one person) are to be held at all levels of command down to the battalion level. Commanders at all levels will ensure their officers and soldiers do not wear unentitled medals while officers and soldiers are mandated not to wear medals until officially promulgated. The following are therefore to be observed:

a. **National Award.** The recipients of national awards will be invited to an Investiture Ceremony and shall personally receive such awards from the President. Where a recipient is unlikely to be present, his/her assigned representative could receive such award on his/her behalf.

b. **Gallantry - (Operational and Non Operational).** The recipients of any gallantry award (Nigeria Star, River Niger Star, Distinguished Service Medal, Nigerian Army Purple Heart, River Benue Star and Nigeria Eagle) will be invited to an Investiture Ceremony and shall personally

receive such medals from the President or his representative.

c. **Campaign and General Service Medals.** These medals will normally be presented by the CDS/COAS or their representative (not below GOC or equivalent appointment) on behalf of the President.

d. **Statutory Award (Grand Service Star, Distinguished Service Star, Meritorious Service Star and Force Service Star).** These awards will be sent to Commanders at all levels (division to battalion) who are to arrange for the presentation to recipient at a suitable parade.

e. **Professional Course Badge.** The graduates of NIPPS, NDC and AFCSC or their equivalent shall personally receive such bars from the President or his delegated representative at an Investiture Ceremony at the Institution concerned. On the other hand, graduands of NA institutions such as AWCN, shall personally receive the Institutions bar from the COAS or his representative.

f. **COAS Commendation Award.** The recipients for COAS Commendation Award are to personally receive such award from the COAS or his appointed representative.

39. **Commanding Officers Parade.** Commanding Officer's Parade is a regimental parade that is held at unit level on a monthly basis. All personnel of the unit attend and the Commanding Officer reviews the parade. All sub-units attached to the unit also form up on the parade. The procedure is the same

40. **Regimental/Battalion Parade.** Regimental/battalion parade is basically a dismounted parade by all regiments and corps. Battalions will parade with 4 companies, sized up and of equal strength, and further divided into not more than 3 platoons. The band will be on parade and will either form up 8 paces in rear of the centre of the parade or, if this is impracticable, on the right flank. Detachments or individual personnel of other arms permanently attached to a unit (e.g LAD EME) may parade with the unit to which they are attached. They will, when possible, form an individual troop/platoon in the headquarters of that unit. The unit parade is the most important forum for fostering discipline, esprit de corps, uniformity in action, good turn out and military bearing. It is the high point in regimentation for any unit. Procedures for this parade are as contained in Ceremonial for the Army 1975. The Commanding Officer commands the parade.

41. **Amalgamation Parade.** Amalgamation parade is held when a new unit is formed by other units contributing sub units. The parade takes the form of a regimental parade with the review and march past by the troops. The highlights include the presentation of the unit flag, mascots and insignia. The importance of this parade is that it is like breathing a new life into a new born baby and it signifies the beginning of the life of the unit. The COAS or his representative presents the unit with the flag which is received by the commanding officer on behalf of his troops.

42. **Disbandment of Unit/Regiment Parade.** Disbandment of unit/regiment parade is held when a unit is being disbanded. A unit can be disbanded to conform to the changes in force structure, or if it is involved in a case of mutiny, losing a battle during a military campaign or as a result of security breach

involving large number of personnel of the unit. When the disbandment of a unit is ordered, published and gazetted, a parade is held. The parade is solemn and sober like a funeral ceremony to signify the end of the unit. During the parade, the flags are lowered, colours are cased for the last time after which they will be taken to the museum and the retreat bugle is sounded.

43. **Handing and Taking Over Parade.** Handing and Taking Over parade otherwise known as “Vesting” Day parade is conducted to mark the end of a command and the commencement of a new one. The importance of this parade is underscored by the following:

- a. It provides the forum for the out-going commander to bid farewell to the officers and soldiers of his unit.
- b. It gives the in-coming commander the opportunity to impress his personality and style of command on the officers and soldiers of his new command in his introductory address.
- c. It enhances a quick rapport between the in-coming commander and the troops of his new unit.

44. **Passing Out Parade.** Passing out parade is conducted in training institutions such as the Nigerian Defence Academy and Depot NA among others to mark the end of training for a set of cadets or recruits respectively. It involves the cadets or recruits marching past and taking their oath of commission or attestation as the case may be.

45. **Trooping and Presentation of Colours.** The trooping and presentation of colours parade is conducted when retiring the old colours of a unit and presenting the unit with a new one. It entails marching/trooping the old colours past the formed up soldiers of



the regiment, retiring the colour, presenting the new colour to the regiment and then consecrating the new colour. The sequence of the procedure is contained in Ceremonials for the Army 1975.

46. **Armed Forces Remembrance Day Parade.** The Armed Forces Remembrance Day Parade holds on 15 January every year. It is the day set aside to remember Service personnel that paid the supreme price during the 2 World Wars, the Nigerian Civil War, Peace Support Operations across the globe, and other operations. It is customary to hold religious services to commemorate the Remembrance Day. The church services and Juma'at prayers are held on the Sunday and Friday preceding the Remembrance Day respectively. These may take place in a church/mosque or at local war memorial. In the case of the church service or Juma'at prayer, there is a set order of service. The Remembrance Day Parade is conducted according to regimental tradition. The National and Regimental Colours are carried on the parade. For procedures of this parade, see Ceremonial for the Army 1975.

47. **Independence Day Anniversary Parade.** The Independence Day Anniversary parade is to commemorate the National Anniversary Day which is held on 1 October yearly. Procedures for this parade are contained in Ceremonial for the Army 1975. The parade is usually mounted in conjunction with other Services and the Nigerian Police as well as para-military organizations. The parade is also conducted in all state capitals of the Federation.

48. **Medals Presentation Parade.** It is customary for the NA to honour deserving officers and soldiers in operations and other fields of endeavour whether local or international. Details of medals are contained in Honours and Awards Medal Handbook 2023.

49. **Democracy Day Parade.** Democracy Day parade is conducted to commemorate the transition from military rule to democracy. It is celebrated on 12 June yearly.

50. **Muster Parade.** Muster Parade is an activity held in a formation, unit, squad or any other type of military establishment to check and account for the members of such establishment. The parade is typically held in the morning before the commencement of the activities of the day and it involves a head count to account for those present. During muster parades, instructions or other vital information are conveyed to personnel to keep them abreast of relevant developments.

51. **Dismissal Parade.** Dismissal Parade is held at the end of working hours to check and account for personnel before they are allowed to retire to their lines. It is organised to ensure that all personnel that were accounted for during the muster parade are complete and intact at the close of work. The dismissal parade is also used as an avenue to disseminate any new information that emanated during the course of the working hours.

## **CEREMONIES**

*"A ceremonial parade, impeccably performed, can never fail to be a source of inspiration to those who watch it or take part in it. It is the noblest and proudest form of drill. Based on the 'blunt whetstone' of drill instruction to recruits it was for many hundreds of years the foundation of battle discipline in all Armies . . .*

***General Sir Harold Alexander,  
Ceremonial for the Army, Ministry for Defence, UK Army  
Department, November 1968***

52. **Wedding Ceremonies.** Wedding ceremonies are

conducted in the NA for officers and soldiers on their wedding day. It is the custom of the NA Officers Corps to 'cross sword' for an officer during a wedding ceremony. This practice originated from the early days when officers bore swords for wars. The minimum number of officers to 'cross sword' during a wedding is 12 formed in file. More officers could 'cross sword' depending on their availability. The ceremony could be held either in the church/mosque, court registry or at the wedding reception venue. During the reception, a sword is presented to the officer for the cutting of his wedding cake. This tradition is borne out of the fact that, in the past, officers carried swords, which were weapons, as part of their military outfit. Swords are still being used by officers but as ceremonial outfit only. During this ceremony, a sword is presented to the officer on behalf of the President C-in-C as a symbol to commemorate the wedding and for the personal protection of his wife. The officer making the presentation should be of the same rank and seniority or subordinate to the officer wedding. For soldiers, the ceremony is similar to that of officers except that there is no 'crossing' of sword. During wedding ceremonies, it is pertinent for officers and soldiers to conduct themselves in manners that portray the NA as a cultured, disciplined and professional organisation. Inappropriate conduct of personnel during wedding ceremonies is prohibited and viewed seriously as prejudicial to Service discipline.

53. **Pulling Out Ceremony.** Pulling Out ceremony is held for retiring senior officers who have served the Army and the Nation and are retiring honourably. It is customary that Generals leaving the Service honourably are 'pulled out' as a sign of respect and final farewell from the Service. This is done immediately after the farewell parade. From the parade ground or officers mess, the retiring officer is expected to enter a waiting 'Land Rover' with ropes tied on it and be pulled out of the barracks gate. Those entitled to this ceremony are officers that attain the rank of Brigadier General and above. Where the spouse of the retiring officer attends the parade, she may stand by her husband as he is 'pulled out'.

54. **Send Off Ceremony.** Send off ceremony has evolved as part of the NA traditions designed to recognize and celebrate retiring/retired as well as discharging/discharged personnel for their contributions to the service of the NA in particular and the country at large. The event is organized annually by the Army Headquarters in the form of regimental dinner night for retiring officers of the rank of brigadier generals and above. The various NA formations shall be responsible for organizing send off ceremony for colonels and below. The criteria for conducting send off ceremony is as follows:

- a. Only personnel who have served the pensionable 10 years and are disengaging under the condition of ROD or voluntary retirement/discharge should be entitled to the send - off ceremony.
- b. The send-off ceremonies for retiring officers should take the form of regimental dinner night, while those of disengaging soldiers shall be organized as valedictory buffet.
- c. The regimental dinner night for officers shall be held at the Division headquarters locations while the valedictory buffet for soldiers shall be held at any of the brigade locations, as decided by the GOC/formation commander.
- d. The COAS or his representative and representative of AHQ DOAA shall be invited to the send - off ceremonies by the various formations.
- e. Retired officers from 4 SF Command shall be merged with AHQ Gar for the purpose of send-off regimental dinner night.
- f. Customized plaques produced on pro rata basis shall be presented as souvenirs to disengaging officers.

- g. Send off ceremonies for personnel of the rank of colonels and below shall be held in the last quarter of the year before the COAS Annual Conference, and included in

55. **Regimental Dinner Night.** Regimental dinner night is a social activity organized by the officers' corps in accordance with laid down regimental procedure. The military places much premium on the hosting of regimental dinner night. It provides a good opportunity for instilling discipline, and training the officers to imbibe acceptable mess etiquette. It is equally a platform to honour retiring NA officers. It also provides an opportunity to interact with honourary members and well placed citizens of the local community. It may be held to honour visiting civil/military dignitaries. The high point of the dinner night is the ' Presidential Loyal Toast' which is proposed by the most junior officer of the unit usually referred to as 'Mr Vice'. The procedures for organizing a regimental dinner night are as stated below:

- a. Arrangement of dinner hall and sitting arrangement will be displayed on the Mess notice board at least 12 hours before the dinner.
- b. Officers turn out for dinner in mess kits (No 3 dress).
- c. Officers acquaint themselves with sitting positions.
- d. Dinner commences with pre-dinner drinks where officers/invited guests meet to exchange pleasantries while band plays music.
- e. Bugler invites officers/invited guests for dinner with 2 Bugle calls.
- f. Mr Vice leads to dinner hall, followed by the most

junior officer.

g. Officers/invited guests are expected to stand by their seats until the President Mess Committee (PMC) and the Guest of Honour take their seats.

h. Quiet conversation is allowed with the immediate officers/invited guests to the left and right but not across the table.

i. Serving of courses commences with the Guest of Honour and PMC being served last.

j. After meals, tables are cleared leaving decanter pots in front of the PMC and Mr Vice.

k. The PMC attracts the attention of Mr Vice for the decanter pots to be passed round for officers/invited guests to fill their glasses for the Loyal Toast.

l. Decanters are passed clockwise without allowing them to drop on the table until every officer/invited guests fills his glass.

m. Mess attendants/stewards withdraw after the wine for toast is served and remain quiet.  
and saying, 'Mr Vice the Loyal Toast'.

n. PMC calls the attention of Mr Vice by hitting the table

o. Mr Vice acknowledges and says, 'gentlemen shall we rise'.

p. Mr Vice says, To the President, Commander in Chief

RESTRICTED

of the Armed Forces of the Federal Republic of Nigeria'. All officers/invited guests are to repeat after Mr Vice.

q. National Anthem is played.

r. The drink is taken and everybody takes his seat.

s. The Guest of Honour or the PMC grants permission for officers/invited guests to smoke if they wish.

t. Speeches are now made by the Guest of Honour and responses by the PMC or any other officer/invited guest as may be permitted.

u. The Guest of Honour, PMC and other officers/invited guests go out to appreciate the band.

v. The following rules are to be observed during regimental dinner night:

(1) Lateness is not allowed.

(2) If there is any reason for lateness, the officer concerned must explain to the PMC.

(3) During the pre-dinner drink, it is advisable to be modest with drinks. This is because it is an act of indiscipline to leave the hall once the dinner commences.

(4) The Guest of Honour must be constantly observed during dinner as officers/invited guests are expected to stop eating once the Guest of Honour stops.

56. **Birth of a Child**. When a child is born to the family of an

officer, the Commander/Commanding Officer is to send a letter of congratulation to the parents on behalf of the formation/unit or regiment. The wives of the formation or unit officers are to pay social visit to the family either with or without a gift. The social visit is to be extended to female officers that give birth. For a soldier, the officer commanding his company does same just as the Commander/Commanding Officer does on behalf of the formation/unit or regiment.

57. **Death.**

a. **Officer or Family Member.** When an officer dies another officer is designated immediately by the Commander or Commanding Officer to render every possible assistance to the bereaved family. A similar courtesy may be rendered, if desired, in the case of the death of a member of an officer's family. A letter of condolence is written by the Commander/Commanding Officer to the bereaved family on behalf of the brigade, regiment or unit. It is also dignifying for a formation or unit to send a delegation to visit the family of the deceased to offer their condolences. On such occasions, it is important that the delegation is properly turned out in a professional manner that reflects the nature of the occasion.

b. **Death of a Soldier.** When a soldier dies, a letter of condolence is written to the Next of Kin by his Commander/Commanding Officer on behalf of the NA. The Commander/Commanding Officer is to arrange immediate assistance that may be necessary to the family until the family is moved out of the barracks accommodation. Similar to the case of the death of an officer, it is dignifying for the formation or unit to send a delegation to visit the family of the deceased.



c. **Death of a Unit Mascot.** When a mascot dies, the Commander/Commanding Officer informs his next higher HQ before conducting a full military burial for the mascot or as may be directed by his Commander/Commanding Officer.

58. **Funeral Ceremonies for Deceased Serving Personnel.** The provision of a funeral with military honours is subject to the conditions laid down in applicable regulations which are to be read in conjunction with any local standing order. When an arrangement of burial is concluded, the following provisions shall apply:

a. **Honours Accorded.** At the funeral of an officer or a soldier, the following will be provided:

- (1) Escorts.
- (2) Firing party.
- (3) Bands and drums.
- (4) Gun carriage or horses.
- (5) Pall bearers.
- (6) Bearers for the coffin.
- (7) Insignia bearers.
- (8) Special party (where applicable).

b. **Drill.** The detail of drill movements required at funeral, with sword, rifle or pistol, is laid down in Drill (All Arms) 1974 Chapter XI. The chapter also laid down a simplified drill should the time available and standard of training not allow for the full detail to be taught for this occasion.

## RESTRICTED

c. **Dress.** All ranks are to wear uniform. Officers are to be in Number 2 Dress while soldiers participating as members of the firing party are to be in Number 1 Dress. Retired personnel who are in possession of uniform may wear it when taking part in the procession on occasion when military honours are accorded at the funeral of an officer or a soldier. Black bands may be worn on the left shoulder during the period of mourning and funeral.

d. **National Flag.** The national flag is to be placed over the coffin. Prior to interment, the national flag will be folded in triangular shape and presented by the Sergeant Major to the Chief Mourner who will in turn present it to the Next of Kin.

e. **Accoutrements and Wreaths.** The head-dress, belt, sword, and boots of the deceased should be placed on the coffin in addition to wreaths. The commander of the Bearer Party must ensure that these and the flag are securely fixed to prevent them from falling. Wreaths not on the coffin will be carried immediately in rear of it. Anyone which cannot be carried on foot will follow the rear escorts in a vehicle.

f. **Mounted Officers and Soldiers.** In the case of the funeral of a mounted officer or soldier, charger on suitable horse will be led by a soldier immediately behind the gun carried or hearse if the former is not available. The boots of the deceased will be placed in the stirrups, but reversed, left boot in the right stirrup and heels to the front.

g. **Escorts.** The escorts will march by companies in threes at the end of the procession in front of the band and drums and at the rear of the procession. The disposal of the

## RESTRICTED

escorts on arrival at the cemetery will be under local arrangement. Further troops will be detailed to line the route.

h. **Firing Party.** A firing party consisting of one sergeant, one corporal and 12 privates will attend to fire volleys at the funeral of all officers below the rank of Major General as well as soldiers. This party should not be confused with escort and the special party. On the occasion of the funerals of Major General and above, the firing party's task will be taken by a leading detachment from the escorts, of the same strength. In marching in slow and quick time, arms will be carried at the 'reverse'. During the march arms may be changed, but the party will not march at ease.

i. **Bearer Party.** The bearer party consists of an officer, warrant officer or non-commissioned officer in charge and 6 to 8 bearers, depending on the circumstances. The rank of the bearers will depend upon the rank of the deceased. As much as possible the bearers should be of equal rank as the deceased.

j. **Paying of Compliments.** The colours of unit forming part of the escort or lining the route will be carried. No compliments will however be paid to them by any unit, parties or individuals, whether military or civil, parading on account of the military funeral. At funerals where troops are detailed to line the route, they will originally be in the 'at ease' position. As the head of the procession approaches, they will rest on their arms reversed, being brought to the 'present' as the coffin passes, and then again rest on their arms reversed.

k. **Flags.** After the end of the burial service, flags will be flown at full mast to indicate the end of military mourning. Mourning bands will be removed by personnel

RESTRICTED

after return to barracks. The detailed procedure for burial of deceased serving personnel is contained in Ceremonial for the Army 1975, Chapter 8 Section 18.

**59. Funeral Ceremonies of Deceased Retired Officers/Discharged Soldiers.** It is customary in the NA to give military burial as a last mark of professional respect to retired or discharged personnel who left the Service honourably. It is important to note that the burial procedure of a deceased officer or soldier from the rank of Private to Major General in the NA is the same. The following shall apply if the Army Headquarters is informed officially of the death of a retired senior officer who was a former Corps Commander, Principal Staff Officer at AHQ level, former General Officer Commanding as well as Brig Gen and above:

- a. Provision of coffin if acceptable to the family of the deceased or an approved amount.
- b. Token financial help to the family, this will be determined by the COAS.
- c. Formation or unit close to the site of burial will provide pall bearers. Last post and reveille will be blown on the bugle.
- d. Letter of Condolence signed by the COAS will be issued.
- e. Provision of security by the formation/unit in whose Area of Responsibility (AOR) the deceased officer is to be buried.

60. For Colonels and Lieutenant Colonels, the following will apply:

- a. Provision of coffin if acceptable to the family of the deceased or an approved amount.

RESTRICTED

- b. Letter of Condolence signed by the COA (A) on behalf of COAS will be issued.
- c. Any token financial assistance to be determined by the last formation/corps of the deceased officer.
- d. Any security assistance from the formation/unit in whose AOR the deceased officer is to be buried.

Officers below the rank of Lieutenant Colonel to Private soldier will be assisted as deemed necessary by the last formation, corps or the unit close to the place of burial.

61. **Street Lining.** Street lining is a ceremony designed to receive a procession or to showcase the military. This tradition could be used by a regiment/unit to welcome troops returning from foreign missions or successful sports men returning from a competition. It has the effect of raising morale of troops returning to the barracks and those receiving them. When a battalion or any part of it lines the street, the Commanding Officer and his Adjutant will be on the flank of the battalion which the procession approaches first, and the senior Major on the other flank. All officers will be offside of the road looking in the direction in which the procession is moving. Company commanders will be on the flank of the companies which the procession approaches first. The colours will also be on the offside of the road, unless they are required for a guard of honour elsewhere. Bands and drums will be posted at suitable places along the route, usually at road junctions or similar places where there is adequate room and opposite the Colour Party where circumstances permit. While it is primarily the task of the police to control the crowds, it must be understood by all officers and soldiers lining the streets that they, no less than the police, are responsible for keeping the route clear. The detailed procedures are contained in Ceremonial for the Army 1975 Chapter 9.

62. **Promotion Decoration.** Promotion decoration ceremony is performed to decorate a newly promoted officer or soldier with his new rank. This is to recognize hard work, honour the recipient and encourage others. It is usually carried out in the mess, the conference room or any other suitable venue with all officers or soldiers and well-wishers in attendance. During the ceremony, the commander with the assistance of any other person (possibly the officer's or soldier's spouse) will decorate the newly promoted officer or soldier. Citation and authority for the promotion should be read before the decoration.

## **MESSES**

63. Messes are recreational facilities in military units, formations and barracks meant for Service personnel to socialize after a hard day's job. They include the Officers' Mess, Warrant Officers/Sergeants' Mess and Soldiers' Club for soldiers of the ranks of corporal and below.

a. **Officers Mess.** The Officers' Mess is regarded as the second home of officers. As an abode for the regiment's colours, the mess is considered as a sacred place and treated with respect and dignity. The rules and regulations guiding the mess differ from unit to unit but all must comply with the standard customs, traditions and ethics of the NA. The following are some of the rules and regulations of the Officers' Mess:

(1) **Courtesy to Senior Officers.** Courtesy to superior officers is part of the mess ethics. When the commander/commanding officer, PMC or senior officer enters the mess, all officers in the mess are to

rise to welcome the senior officer. They are to be seated when the senior officer may have taken his seat. Subordinate officers are not to be afraid to enter into a conversation with senior officers or guests in the mess.

(2) **Courtesy to Visitors.** Courtesy to visitors is desirable in the Officers' Mess. When a known or unknown visitor comes in to the mess, an officer must act as his/her host. The mess is judged by the way visitors are received. An officer is to offer them tea or drinks, depending on the time of visit. If they have come to call on the mess or are members of a visiting team, the staff are to be instructed afterwards to put drinks down to 'mess guest'. This is the duty of any host, and an officer is not to bear the cost of entertaining visitors or guests of the unit, except as general charge of all members of the mess. When an officer brings visitors to the mess, he is to introduce the visitor to the PMC or any other senior officer in the mess at that time. Also, an officer is responsible for the good behaviour of his guest.

(3) **Cleanliness and Tidiness.** Cleanliness and tidiness of the Officers' Mess is the responsibility of all. The mess staff are to be assisted in keeping the mess tidy. Newspapers and magazines are to be returned to the shelves provided for this purpose. Cigarette butts/ashes are to be put into the ash trays provided for them.

(4) **Senior Subaltern.** The senior subaltern is responsible for the behaviour of all subalterns both in and out of the mess. It is his job to give advice to all subaltern officers and to put them right when they

make mistakes. Young officers are encouraged to clear their doubts about procedure or mess customs from their superiors.

(5) **Mess Entertainment.** Mess entertainment is normally an organized function to which members of other messes and civilians in the neighbourhood may be invited. Officers on this function will have to act as hosts. This means spending time and money. In most messes, subscriptions to entertainment are made on a pro-rata-basis. It should also be remembered that a party in the mess, as it would be in their own home, is for the enjoyment of the guests and not solely for the officers themselves. They should therefore act accordingly and see that the guests do enjoy themselves.

(6) **Complaints.** Complaints in the running of the Officers' Mess are to be directed to the appropriate mess official. An officer should not find fault with, or complain to the mess staff unless he is a member of the mess committee. If he has complaints to make, he is to approach one of the members of the mess committee or the mess secretary. The suggestion book is not the place for complaints, it should be used for constructive suggestions to assist the mess committee.

(7) **Mess Bills.** Mess bills are to be settled by all members. Not only is it a laid down regulation that mess bills must be paid on or before the seventh day of each month but it is also a point of honour that they be paid immediately on receipt. It is an officer's responsibility to see that payment of the mess bill is carried out. If mess bills are produced late, they must be settled within 7 days of receipt.



b. **WOs/Sgts' Mess**. The WOs/Sgts mess as the name implies is meant for warrant officers and sergeants. The prestige of a regiment or unit depends to a great extent upon the standard of the mess. A well run mess will ensure contented and hardworking members. Officers are not to visit the WOs/Sgts mess unless invited for an occasion and must leave as soon as the occasion ends.

c. **The Soldiers' Club**. The soldiers' club is organised like a mess and is meant for the recreation of corporals and below. Goods are sold in the club at a subsidized rate for soldiers to buy. This goes a long way in keeping the soldiers in the barracks so that they can be mobilized at short notice for any assignment. Indoor games such as Ludo, Monopoly and Chess are to be provided to keep soldiers busy

64. **Mess Initiation**. It is customary in the NA for an officer newly posted to a unit to be initiated into the Officers' Mess of his new unit or formation. This is done when the officer completes the unit routine and schedule of duties, through an orientation course or cadre and the Commanding Officer being convinced that the officer is familiar with the unit routine and schedule of duties. Orientation course is necessary before an officer is initiated, especially for young officers newly commissioned from the Nigerian Defence Academy. This would enable the new officers understand and appreciate the customs and traditions of their new units. The procedure for initiation vary from unit to unit depending on the customs being practised in such unit. However, the following procedure could be followed:

a. On arrival to the unit, the new officer reports to the unit Adjutant and fills a proforma containing:

- (1) Marital status.
- (2) Courses attended.

- (3) Units served.
  - (4) Appointments held.
  - (5) Hobbies.
- b. Adjutant informs Commanding Officer of the new officer's arrival.
  - c. Commanding Officer fixes a date he would see the officer.
  - d. Battalion Second in Command draws up programme for the officers' orientation course if they are many, otherwise, the unit adjutant would put the officer through the unit's routine and schedule of duties.
  - e. The unit Second in Command/Adjutant informs the Commanding Officer that the new officer is through with the orientation and he is therefore ready for initiation.
  - f. The Commanding Officer fixes a date for the initiation and the unit Second in Command, who is also the PMC, works out details of the initiation. On the day of initiation, which is usually the day of the unit officers' get-together, the following events are expected to take place:
    - (1) Officers assemble in unit's mess with the drum platoon in attendance.
    - (2) The PMC introduces the officer to be initiated, and announces to the house the mode of the initiation.
    - (3) The secretary of the mess reads the curriculum vitae of the officer to be initiated.

## RESTRICTED

(4) Appropriate initiation is administered in line with the unit/regimental traditions. The Officers' Mess initiation should reflect moderation with respect to drinks and exercises.

(5) Finally, the officer is decorated with the unit/regiment's insignia and the bugler sounds fanfare signifying the end of the initiation.

65. **Tombola**. Tombola is a mess activity where military personnel entertain themselves and interact with civilians within NA messes. The activity typically entails raffle draws and games where prizes could be won. Supporters of the mess usually donate prizes in advance or the mess could sponsor same. Additionally, the sale of tickets for the raffle draws could be leveraged to generate funds for the mess.

66. **Mess Get-Together**. Mess Get-together is a mess function where NA personnel of a formation/unit wine and dine either in the officers or soldiers messes. It is an opportunity for members of the mess to deliberate on mess and formation/unit issues in a relaxed forum. The Mess Get-together is chaired by the President Mess Committee (PMC) and on some occasions the Patron of the mess could be in attendance.

67. **Wining-in and Wining-out Ceremonies**. The wining-in and wining-out ceremonies are traditions in NA messes where newly posted in NA personnel are welcomed and inducted into the mess and sent-off when posted out respectively.

68. **Happy Hour**. Happy hour are mess activities organised intermittently to get members of the mess socialise. It is usually at the discretion of the PMC.

## **COLOURS FLAGS PORTRAITS AND MASCOTS**

69. **Colours**. The National and Unit Colours carried during

parades and ceremonial activities are called the National and Regimental Colours respectively. The origin of colours dates back to the early days, when men, fixed their family badge to a pole and held it aloft in battle for the dual purpose of indicating their position and as a rallying point should the occasion arise. Medieval chivalry followed the same idea when armorial bearings were placed on their banners so that these could be seen well above the melee. When armies were beginning to adopt a system of regimentation at the beginning of the Seventeenth Century, each company was allotted a colour, a custom which persists till date. The sight of the colours creates a feeling of pride in soldiers and ex-soldiers. From ancient history, it has served as an inspiration for heroic acts of self-sacrifice. Colours have become the symbol of the fighting spirit of a regiment, for they bear the battle honours and badges granted to the regiment in commemoration of the gallant deeds performed by its troops from the time it was raised. Victories in the olden days were sometimes expressed in terms of the number of enemy soldiers captured. This association of the colours with the heroic deeds of the unit emblazoned on them has led to the custom of regarding the colours with veneration. The fact that colours are consecrated and presented before being taken into use, and after service are laid up in sacred or public buildings, helps to maintain the atmosphere of veneration with which they are surrounded. Colours are presented to combat and combat support units/regiments only.

70. **Rendering Honour to the Colour.** Rendering honour to the Colour is an integral part of the NA tradition. The Nigerian National Flag is the symbol of our nation. The National Colour is always accorded its due honour when paraded with other colours by being flown on the right of other colours. All officers, soldiers and their families as well as invited guests are expected to rise when the colours march past them during military ceremonies

and parades. Officers and warrant officers in uniform are to salute the colours. The colours will be left flying as the caution given for presidential or general salute, and in marching past between points. The colours must be caught immediately after 'Eyes Front' is given.

71. **Regimental Colour.** The Regimental Colour shows various patches of honours/campaigns a unit has taken part in. It is therefore the unit's heritage and must be treated with pride. Furthermore, it is inappropriate for it to be used by another unit nor loaned for whatever reason.

72. **Occasions when Colours are Carried.** The occasions when Colours are carried are specified in the Ceremonials for the Army 1975. The National and Regimental Colours are carried on all ceremonial parades such as National, Independence, Armed Forces Remembrance, Change of Guards, Guard of Honour, Trooping of Colour parades and other national ceremonies.

73. **Colours in Officers' Mess.** Keeping of Colours in Officers' Mess is an ancient tradition practised since the modern revolution in military affairs. When not on parade, colours are normally kept in the colour stands in the officer's mess. The customary method of placing the colour in the stand is as contained in Ceremonial for the Army 1975.

74. **Colours in Places of Worship.** Colours in places of worship is the display of colours during a church parade or other appropriate services. The colours may be deposited in a place of worship or paraded as part of the Church service. This is not to be confused with the laying up of Colours. The detailed procedure for Colours in Church is contained in Ceremonial for the Army 1975.

75. **Flags, Pennants and Guidons.** Flags, Pennants and Guidons are unit identification symbols displayed in offices, messes and also during ceremonial parades. The flags to be hoisted by NA units and formations are the National, the NA, formation and unit flags. The National Flag will however, be flown at a higher level than others and at the right of all flags. These flags are expected to be flown daily unless otherwise directed. In such cases, it will be specified in the routine orders. The National Flag or any flag will not be flown in a defaced or bad condition. It is an offence under Section 5 of the Flags and Coat of Arms Act CAP F30 Laws of the Federation of Nigeria 2004 to fly the flag in a defaced or bad condition. Whenever flags are flown, they will be placed in the following order with the National Flag always on the right:

- a. National Flag.
- b. Defence Flag (where applicable).
- c. Nigerian Army Flag.
- d. The Formation/Corps Flag.
- e. Unit or Regimental Flag.

76. **Flying of Flags at Half Mast.** The flying of flags at half-mast is an old military tradition to honour fallen heroes. Flags will be flown at half-mast on the directive of Army Headquarters or as may be directed. In addition, the unit flag is to be flown at half-mast when a unit officer, soldier or the mascot dies.

77. **Commander's Presence Flag.** The Commander's Presence Flag is a formation/unit flag of smaller dimension than the usual formation/unit flags. This is flown when the Commander/Commanding Officer is in the office and it is normally hoisted in an inclined position away from the other

flags but in a conspicuous place at the entrance into the headquarters complex. The commander's presence flag should be 30 inches long and 22.5 inches wide.

78. **Flags in Messes.** Flags are part of the decoration in the mess. Formations and units will display the authorized flags mentioned in Paragraph 75 a-e less 75 b behind the PMC's seat.

79. **Period to Fly Flags.** Period to fly flags is from reveille to retreat daily. In other words, the flags are to be flown from 0600hrs to 1800hrs daily.

80. **Guidons.** Guidons originated from knights of the Middle Ages and are similar to the small triangular flags used on naval ships for identification. The Guidon is a company, battery, or troop identification flag. It is present at all unit/formations parades unless otherwise directed by the commander. The position of the guidon is directly behind the Commanding Officer whether the parade is mounted or dismounted.

81. **Flying of Pennants on Official Vehicles.** The flying of pennants on official vehicles is to signify the presence of the commander or staff officer so designated. Pennants are to be flown only when the commander/staff officer is in the vehicle and all ranks are expected to salute all military vehicles flying pennants. The following officers of the NA are entitled to fly flags/pennants on their official vehicles:

- a. Chief of Army Staff.
- b. Commander Training and Doctrine Command (TRADOC).
- c. Army Commandants of Tri-Service Institutions.

- d. General Officer Commanding (GOC).
- e. Corps Commanders.
- f. Principal Staff Officers (AHQ) and Military Secretary (MS 'A').
- g. Commandants of Nigerian Army Schools.
- h. Brigade Commanders.
- i. Officers on acting appointment will fly the flag of the office in which they are acting.

82. **Additional instructions relating to flags and pennants.**

Additional instructions relating to flags and pennants are:

- a. All flags/pennants will bear in their centre, the formation/directorate symbols while the Chief of Army Staff and AHQ Principal Staff Officers' flags will bear the NA symbol.
- b. Pennants will be 9 inches long and 6 inches wide.
- c. Pennants will be carried on the bonnet of the vehicle.
- d. A pennant will only be flown when the officer for whom it is authorized is present in the vehicle.
- e. Flags and pennants will only be flown from 0600hrs to 1800hrs, from reveille to retreat, after which all flags will be covered with cases.
- f. Other details on the shape and measurement of pennants are contained in NA Dress Regulations.

83. **Portraits.** Portraits are enlarged photographs of persons who are in position of authority both in civil and military hierarchy. It is customary to display these portraits as a mark of honour and loyalty to the persons concerned. Locations in which



## RESTRICTED

these portraits may be displayed include commander's office, officers' mess, WOs/Sgt mess, soldiers club and commander's official residence. They are also displayed in honour rooms, hall of fame or unit heritage rooms. The standard size of a portrait should not be larger than 40 x 50cm and it should be on a wooden frame displayed at right angles inclined. The following are the personages whose portraits are to be displayed at NA formations and units:

- a. President, Commander in Chief of the Armed Forces.
- b. Honourable Minister of Defence.
- c. Minister of State for Defence (Army).
- d. Chief of Defence Staff.
- e. Chief of Army Staff.
- f. General Officers Commanding.
- g. Corps Commanders.
- h. Commandants of NA/Tri Service Training Institutions.
- i. Brigade and Formation Commanders.
- j. Commanding Officers.
- k. Commanders of independent sub units.

The President's portrait must be in all military establishments. It is to be displayed in offices, commander's official residence and messes. Portraits as listed below are to be displayed in the following NA formations/units:

a. **AHQ.**

(1) **COAS Office and Residence.**

- (a) President.
- (b) Honourable Minister of Defence.
- (c) Minister of State for Defence (Army).
- (d) Chief of Defence Staff.
- (e) Chief of Army Staff.

(2) **Public Gallery.**

- (a) President.
- (b) Honourable Minister of Defence.
- (c) Minister of State for Defence (Army).
- (d) Chief of Defence Staff.
- (e) Portraits of past COAS.

(3) **Other Offices in AHQ.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.

b. **TRADOC/Divisions/Corps/AHQ Garrison.**

(1) **Commander (Office and Residence).**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.
- (c) Commander/GOC/Commandant.

(2) **Public Gallery.**

- (a) President.

- (b) COAS.
- (c) Commander.
- (d) Portraits of past commanders.

(3) **Other Offices.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.
- (c) Commander.

c. **NA/Tri Service Training Institutions.**

(1) **Commandant's Office.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.
- (c) Corps Commander (where applicable).
- (d) Commandant (where applicable).

(2) **Public Gallery.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.
- (c) Commandant.
- (d) Past Commandants.

(3) **Other Offices.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.

- (c) Corps Commander/Commandant (where applicable).
- (d) Commandant.

d. **Brigades.**

(1) **Commander's Office.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.
- (c) GOC.
- (d) Corps Commander/Commandant (where applicable).
- (e) Commander.

(2) **Public Gallery.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.
- (c) GOC.
- (d) Corps Commander/Commandant (where applicable).
- (e) Commander.
- (f) Past Commanders.

(3) **Other Offices.**

- (a) President.
- (b) COAS.

- (c) GOC.
- (d) Commander.

e. **Battalions/Regiments/Units.**

- (1) President.
- (2) COAS.
- (3) GOC.
- (4) Corps Commander/Commandant (where applicable).
- (5) Commander.
- (6) Commanding Officer.

f. **Independent Sub-Units.**

- (1) President.
- (2) COAS.
- (3) Commander.
- (5) Unit Commander.

84. **Mascots.** Mascots are objects, animals or persons that are chosen as a symbol of a regiment. The unit usually identifies with the general characteristics of chosen mascot such as the stealth, resilience or strength inherent in the mascot. The mascot contributes in no small measure to the morale and psychological spirit of the troops. Mascots, especially tamed animals, may be brought to the parade ground during ceremonial parade involving the regiment. All

battalions/regiments are expected to have their own mascots which must be approved by AHQ and Army Number allotted to them for payment of personal emoluments. The salary paid to the Mascots is for their up keep and maintenance.

## SALUTE

85. Salute is perhaps the oldest and most ubiquitous military tradition. It is an expression of reciprocal loyalty between a superior and subordinates. Most commonly expressed by hand, salute can also be rendered by guns, swords, banners or music. The salute by hand originates from the traditional declaration, 'I hold nothing to harm you'. Salute is derived from the Latin word, *salutare*, which means, **“to greet”**. Salute is normally initiated by the subordinate to his superior. When a group of soldiers are on out-door engagement, the senior person in charge salutes for the detail while others continue working. On such occasion, there might be the need for the senior person to caution the group before rendering the salute. A final rifle salute is fired at the grave side of a fallen soldier, 3 volleys are fired by a burial party. Salute is not only prescribed by regulation but also a recognition of each other's commitment and professionalism therefore it must be acknowledged. There is no time limit for the hand salute. All officers and soldiers are required to pay the normal compliments to their superiors in rank, who are authorized to receive such compliments, whether riding on horseback, on a cycle, in a private car or a service vehicle. It is an officer's duty to return a salute smartly, with the correct hand and without a cigarette or pipe in the mouth. In particular:

- a. When returning a salute, an officer should breast up also and look towards the person whose salute he is returning. An officer must remember to return a salute and not merely acknowledge it.

b. When a body of troops are in motion and an officer is saluted, he is to remain at attention, take the salute and move on when the soldiers have passed him or when their commander gives them 'eyes front'.

c. When 2 or more officers are saluted, only the most senior should return the salute while the rest are to breast up.

d. When a superior officer enters an office where a subordinate officer is seated in front of an officer senior to the one who enters, the subordinate officer should remain seated but breast up when the officer salutes. He may then extend his own compliments – Good Day Sir or Good Morning, as the case may be.

86. **Gun Salute.** Gun salute is the traditional firing of artillery guns to either welcome a visiting personage or during certain military parades. The use of field artillery for gun salute during ceremonial parades was not in practice until the Nineteenth Century. Initially, field artillery was required to line up their guns without firing. However, when the firing of the guns as a mark of honour was introduced into ceremonial parades, the guns were moved out of the formation line to avoid injury to other elements in the parade. The NA fires gun salutes to honour visiting Presidents, dignitaries and during the Armed Forces Remembrance Day Parade as well as State funerals of late Presidents or Heads of State including State functions as may be prescribed. For procedures see Ceremonial for the Army 1975.

## **ETIQUETTE**

87. Etiquette of the NA comprises written and unwritten conventions of polite social behaviour expected of NA officers and soldiers. They include polite behaviour and conduct

expected of NA personnel at the work place, during social functions and in their day to day interactions with other persons and organizations. For example, a subordinate officer will rise if a superior officer enters the room. At social functions, it is expected that the subordinate officer will seek out the senior officer and initiate conversation. The subordinate officer should listen to the senior officer and should not dominate the talk. At dinners and banquets, one is expected to converse with those on the right, left and across to his immediate front. To ignore anyone close is a serious breach of courtesy. It is particularly necessary to observe the best etiquette while using cell phones during meetings, gatherings or in the presence of superiors. The whole essence of etiquette is to ensure personnel's behaviour and conduct are guided by the need to be respectful, humble and honourable which are the hallmark of a gentleman.

## **COURTESIES**

88. Courtesies refer to good manners and politeness in dealing with other people. Courteous behaviour provides a basis for developing good human relations. Military courtesy is the respect shown to each other by members of the Armed Forces. It includes the hand salute, standing at attention and addressing others by their rank. It is always considered good manners for a younger person to say sir or madam when speaking to an older person or a superior officer. It is expected that subordinates will offer their seats to their superiors when there are insufficient seats at any occasion.

## **STARTING THE MILITARY CAREER**

89. The military is a peculiar profession and its manpower must be specially trained to prepare them to meet the rigours and high expectations of the career. Right from the start of their



military career, all NA personnel must be introduced to the core values of the Service which they are expected to consciously imbibe, develop and uphold. The traditions, customs and ethics of the NA form a good starting point to understanding the core values and must therefore be taught in NDA and Depot NA. On completion of training, successful cadets and recruits are commissioned and attested, respectively and posted to corps, formations and units to start their career in the NA having these values, traditions, customs and ethics as guiding principles.

### **ORIENTATION CADRE**

90. An orientation cadre is organized for officers and soldiers as soon as they are posted to formations or corps headquarters. This is a transitional period when the young officers and soldiers would be further enlightened on the traditions, customs and ethics of the NA and those other aspects peculiar to their various arms and services. The standing orders of the corps and units they are posted to would be made available to them. After the orientation cadre, the young officers and soldiers would be in good frame of mind to commence their routine military career without much doubt.

### **REGIMENTAL ACTIVITIES**

91. All officers and soldiers must participate in regimental activities and where they are not participating, they must be present to watch and support participants. Recreational activities like sports and games are to be encouraged as they promote esprit-de-corps.

### **BUGLE CALLS**

92. Bugle calls are timed sounding of the bugle in military

establishments to signal specific activity. The bugle call has its root in the days when bugles were used to communicate orders to large groups of soldiers on noisy battle field. The purpose of the bugle calls is to order the activities of the soldiers. The following are brief explanations of some of the more common bugle calls:

- a. **First Call.** First call is the first bugle call of the day, given as warning that reveille is to take place within a few minutes.
- b. **Reveille.** Reveille is a French word 'Reveiller' to arouse, or awaken, originally from the Latin word 'Evigilare' meaning to watch, to wake. The tradition of sounding some sort of call to signify the beginning of the day is very ancient. The British adopted the practice from the French and were calling it 'reveilly' as early as 1644. In the Army and if you are still in bed when 'Reveille' is sounded you are late. But 'Reveille' has come into the Army vocabulary as the word for the bugle call signifying the beginning of the day's work.
- c. **Mess Call.** Mess call is used to alert troops that meal is ready. In the olden days, this call was affectionately dubbed 'soupy' to indicate that it was time for meal. During the regimental dinner night, the bugle may be sounded at the instance of the PMC to indicate that the dinner is ready.
- d. **Last Post.** Last post is the musical bugle tone sounded at the end of a military funeral. It is also used to signify the end of the year in the regiment or unit. When it is sounded, all personnel are to come to attention and officers and warrant officers in uniform are to salute. This bugle call signifies the end of an era.

e. **Tattoo Call.** For tattoo call, see Paragraph 29.

f. **Call to the Colour.** Call to the Colour is the bugle call sounded during retreat. The first note of the bugle signals that the flag is to be lowered. While this call is being sounded, military personnel in uniform will salute.

g. **Orders Call.** Orders call is the bugle call that is sounded prior to the commencement of summary trial in a regiment/unit. It entails calling all the witnesses and accused to attention and reporting to the Trial Officer. It is sounded to draw the attention of all soldiers in the orderly room and the unit to the fact that trial is in progress.

h. **Part One Orders Call.** Part I Orders Call is sounded to draw attention of troops to the fact that a new Part One Orders/Routine Orders has just been released. It is intended to direct troops to the nearest notice board to read the contents of the unit/formation Part 1/Routine Orders.

i. **Commencement of Work Call.** Commencement of Work Call is sounded at the start of working hours to signify the commencement of the day's work. This is usually by 0800hrs in a regiment/unit except on morning PT days.

j. **End of Work Call.** End of Work Call is sounded at the close of working hours by 1400 hours in a regiment or unit to signal the close of office work for the day.

k. **Double Call.** Double call is sounded to assemble the troops at a particular location.

## **INDIGENOUS SONGS**

93. Indigenous songs are compositions rendered as a means of boosting morale particularly during physical training exercise and operations. This is a notable part of NA traditions which is now being relegated. Efforts must be made to resuscitate this tradition.

## **DUTY OFFICER**

94. An officer should always bear in mind that, while carrying out the duties of the duty officer, he is representing the Commander/Commanding Officer. It is therefore essential that these duties are carried out conscientiously and to the best of his ability. The following aspects are very important and must be carefully noted:

a. **Instructions to Duty Officers.** Every officer on first joining his unit will be given special instruction in the particular duties that he will have to carry out as duty officer. He must understand these duties thoroughly and perform them with keenness, for the way in which he carries out the instructions will undoubtedly be carefully noticed by his Commander/Commanding Officer.

b. **Dress.** The duty officer must be smartly turned out at all times in Number 6 dress for 24 hours of his duty and must remain in uniform except he retires to bed or when he is given special permission by the Adjutant to take part in regimental games. In a theatre of operation, the duty officer must dress smartly in line with the particular dress code for the operation, such as Number 6 dress (Woodland or Desert colour).

c. **Duties.** The duties of the duty officer vary greatly in different units. The following paragraphs apply chiefly to a duty officer in an infantry battalion. In the Nigeria Army Engineers and the Artillery, those duties are often performed under squadron or battery arrangements. Nevertheless, the principles outlined in subsequent paragraphs remain the same in all units.

(1) **Visiting Dining Halls.** When the duty officer visits the dining hall at meal times, it is not merely sufficient for him to appear for a few minutes. He should take a personal interest in the quality of the food and the method of service. Fictitious complaints must not be entertained and the offender should have disciplinary action taken against him.

(2) **Mounting and Dismounting the Guard or Piquet.** When mounting or dismounting the guard or piquet, the duty officer must be faultlessly turned out. This is the least that is expected of him. The inspection must be thorough and no fault must be allowed to pass without the necessary action being taken. It is an officer's duty to know the correct procedure before going on parade, and also to ensure that the drill is correctly and smartly carried out.

(3) **Visiting the Guard or Piquet.** It is one of the duties of the duty officer to visit the guard or piquet once by day and once by night. The object of these visits is to ensure that men are correctly dressed and thoroughly at alert so that they can turn out at short notice. It is therefore useless if the visits are always carried out at the hour. It is the duty officer's duty to be conscientious in this task, and he should therefore, vary the period he goes round to check the guards.

## RESTRICTED

Guards and piquets may have tactical positions to take up on being turned out, as well as on ceremonial occasions. The officer must ensure that all men know these positions and understand the orders.

(4) **Duty Report.** At the end of his tour of duty, the duty officer must write a comprehensive report using the appropriate proforma.

## **HONOURS AND AWARDS**

95. It is a long standing tradition of the military to honour officers and soldiers who have excelled through gallantry, hard work and exemplary conduct. The NA has therefore, in the Handbook on Honours and Awards Medals, outlined honours and awards that could be conferred on personnel. Honouring of personnel through awards of medals is a morale booster. It also enhances the revival of military customs and cherished values. In this regards, medals are awarded in elaborate ceremonies which bestow pride to Service personnel. The following are the categories of Honours and Awards that could be conferred on officers and soldiers of the NA. Further details are contained in the Honours and Awards Medals 2023 booklet:

- a. Nigerian National Honours and Awards Medals.
- b. Foreign National Honours and Awards Medals.
- c. Service Honours and Awards Medals.
- d. Special Honours and Awards Medals.

## **DRESS, UNIFORM AND INSIGNIA**

96. **Dress Regulations.** Uniforms, with their accoutrements,

are distinctive dresses worn by soldiers to distinguish them professionally while at the same time differentiating them by Service, Corps and Nationality. When properly used, uniforms, serve as a source of pride and esprit-de-corps. Uniforms include the weapons and other combat gears the soldiers carry. Uniforms must be sewn to specification and worn according to the dress regulations of the Army. The Dress Regulations for the NA are issued under the authority of the Army Council and are intended as a guide for all ranks in the NA. Service personnel should ensure that they are fully conversant with these regulations and that they are strictly observed. The Army Council has powers to make amendments to the regulations as may be deemed necessary from time to time in the interest of the Service.

97. **Order of Dress Officers.** The order of dress for officers is as follow:

- a. No 1 Dress - Ceremonial Dress.
- b. No 2 Dress - Service Dress.
- c. No 3 Dress - Mess Dress.
- d. No 4 Dress - Working Dress (Jacket & Trousers).
- e. No 5 Dress - Working Dress (Shirt and Trousers).
- f. No 6 Dress - Operational Dress (Camouflage).
- g. No 7 Dress - Working Dress (Shirt and Trousers with Forage Cap).

The sewing specifications and articles for each type of dress are contained in Nigerian Army Dress Regulations 2023.

98. **Order of Dress Soldiers.** The order of dress for soldiers is as stated below:

- a. No 1 Dress - Ceremonial Dress.
- b. No 4 Dress - Working Dress (for Master Warrant Officers and Army Warrant Officers).

- c. No 5 Dress - Working/Training Dress.
- d. No 6 Dress - Operational Dress (Camouflage).
- e. No 7 Dress - Working Dress (Shirt and Trousers with Forage Cap).

The sewing specification and article for each type of dress are contained in Nigerian Army Dress Regulations 2023.

99. **Order of Dress Female Officers/Soldiers.** The Dress regulations and variations in patterns including articles to be fitted in the female officers and soldiers dress class are contained in NA Dress Regulation 2023.

100. **Embellishments and Accoutrements.** Any embellishment and or accoutrement to be worn on approved uniforms are to be the pattern authorized and issued by NAOC as approved by the Army Headquarters. Details of embellishments and accoutrements are contained in NA Dress Regulations 2023.

101. **Approved Shoulder Flashes.** The Dress Regulation 2023 also authorizes shoulder flashes for formations and corps. Such shoulder flashes should consist of the Formation/Corps Logo with Formation/Corps colours in the background. The Formation/Corps Motto is inscribed neatly on the flashes.

102. **Occasions for Wearing Uniform.** Service personnel will wear uniform:

- a. While on Duty.
- b. When on courier or escort duties.



103. **Occasions for not Wearing Uniform.** Service personnel will not wear any form of uniform:

- a. When dancing in restaurants, hotels or public places except when attending official social functions.
- b. When traveling on leave except from an operation area.

104. **Clothing After Retirement/Discharge.** All retired/discharged officers/soldiers will be dekitted in accordance with Manning Regulations. Officers on retirement or being compulsorily retired will be allowed to retain their dresses and equipment less the following:

- a. Web equipment complete.
- b. Training/Operations dress.
- c. Working dress suits.
- d. Identity Card.
- e. Identity Disc.

Further provisions on the use of military dress for occasions by retired/discharge officers/soldiers are spelt out in the NA Dress Regulation 2023.

105. **Decorations and Medals.** The use of Decorations and Medals is guided by the following rules:

- a. Decorations and Medals except otherwise indicated are worn on the left breast in horizontal line suspended from a single bar of which no part is to be seen or stitched to the

garment. Medals are to be placed immediately above the line with the first button of the jacket.

b. When Brooch, Clasp/Tab is or are earned, it or they will be worn nearest to the medal.

c. National Honour Medals will be worn in a horizontal line suspended from a single bar on the chest.

d. When ribbons are worn, each ribbon will be 3cm long and 1cm wide. The maximum number of ribbons on a bar will be 4.

106. **Haircut**. A good haircut contributes to the bearing of officers and soldiers. They are therefore required to always maintain low haircut and have their mustache well trimmed. They are not to have goatee and side burns. The women can keep their hair or braid it but it must not extend below the neck. Male and female personnel are not to dye their hairs to any colour other than black. The female personnel is also not expected to put on any form of coloured or artificial hair that is in contrast with the original colour of the female personnel's hair.

107. **Wearing of Beret**. When officers and soldiers are wearing the beret, the badge must be aligned with the left eyebrow and the beret is bent to the right. The beret's seem should be worn slightly above the eyebrow. The colour of the berets differentiate the corps. The details of the colours and other aspects concerning wearing of berets are specified in NA Dress Regulations.

108. **Identity**. Identity Card (AF107) must always be carried by all Service personnel whether inside or outside the barracks and in or out of uniform. It is the most important form of official identity for a soldier. It must be produced on request by

authorized personnel/persons, civil or military. The loss of this document must be reported immediately and published in Part 1 Orders. On no account should an officer or soldier be denied his identity card except as provided in Terms and Conditions of Service.

109. **Traditional/Civil Dresses**. Officers and soldiers of the NA when attending formal functions requiring a civil dress must wear a complete suit or traditional attire. Such an attire must be complete with an appropriate cap, or head tie in the case of female officers and soldiers. The turnout of personnel must meet the highest standards of decency and respectability.

## **MISCELLANEOUS DECORUM**

110. **Relationship between Officers and Soldiers**. Relationship between officers and soldiers is based upon firm and friendly foundation of respect without any familiarity. Both officers and soldiers have the utmost confidence in each other and a profound sense of pride in belonging to the same Army.

111. **Attitude towards Subordinates**. It is an accepted custom of the NA and in the best interest of good discipline that a superior officer will not admonish his subordinate be he an officer, warrant officer or non-commissioned officer in the presence of subordinates or more particularly, personnel under the subordinate's command.

112. **Familiarity with Subordinates**. It is improper for an officer to get too familiar or 'personal' with a soldier. The same applies generally in official dealings with subordinate officers. Since regulations and customs forbid a military man being familiar with his superiors, it is only common decency that the superior should govern his own conduct accordingly. This

custom is not snobbery but is dictated by sound psychological principles that have been periodically challenged and proved to be valid. Familiarity does breed contempt. This is not to say however, that an officer should not have interest in the welfare of his soldiers.

113. **Use of 'Sir'**. As a general rule, 'Sir' is used in speaking either officially or socially to any superior. The word is repeated with each complete statement. 'Yes' or 'No' should not be used in speaking to a superior without including 'Sir'. However, 'Sir' should not be used at every breath to the point of being slavish.

114. **Smoking**. Officers and soldiers must not smoke while on the parade ground. They must not smoke with headgear on. All are to observe 'No Smoking' sign when posted and never smoke in an automobile if there are non-smokers present. While it is permissible to smoke out door, it is never done at ceremonies such as military parades or funerals or while wearing gloves. When on duty post, subordinate must observe the presence of the most senior person present. In public places, do not light up cigarette without first asking other persons present, 'Do you mind if I smoke'. It is improper for Service personnel to be seen smoking while in uniform on the following occasions:

- a. Saluting.
- b. Moving outside the office.
- c. Marching with troops, except during halts.
- d. On parade, parade ground or at the range.
- e. Acting as a reviewing officer at his post, or at a sport meet, obstacle course etc. If he desires to smoke during a suitable interval when he is not required to be at his post, Service personnel must remove head dress and do so at an

appropriate place.

f. At a conference or lecture unless permitted to do so by the senior officer present.

115. **Courtesy to Officers' Wives.** All officers must greet officers' spouses on meeting them. It is a sign of being a gentleman. All officers irrespective of their rank will greet an officer's spouse even if the officer is a subaltern. Officers' spouses when greeted are equally expected to respond accordingly with respect. A formal hand salute is not part of the courtesy to officers' spouses.

116. **The Magajiya.** This is a Hausa word meaning – women leader. It is an old tradition in the NA to keep and maintain Magajiya. They serve as link to the Commanding Officer through the Regimental Sergeant Major (RSM). They mobilize soldiers' wives to ensure harmony and cleanliness of the barracks.

117. **The Commander.** It is an old custom of the Service to refer to the Commander as the 'papa' or 'baba'. This form of reference is made out of a sense of affection and respect for the Commander. It is never made within their hearing. In more recent times, it is customary for the Commander or Commanding Officer to be referred to as the 'father' or 'mother' of the unit or formation, as the case may be.

118. **Official Knock.** One rap on the door is considered to be official knock and is the warning for persons in that room to be ready for an official visit. The 'Official Knock' might be used by Battalion Commander entering a Company Commander's office while other officers and soldiers of the company entering into the same office would knock twice.

119. **Courtesy Calls by Visiting Officers.**

a. **Commander.** It is an accepted practice for Commanders/Commanding Officers to make their presence known to their formation Commanders on arrival and departure.

b. **Officers and Soldiers on Leave/Passes.** Officers and soldiers on leave or passes may be required to report their presence to the nearest Military/Police unit. This will enable the officer or soldier to be located when needed.

120. **Social Calls.** Social calls are calls by officers or soldiers on their superiors or colleagues to show solidarity in time of joy or sadness. Social calls foster spirit of togetherness and esprit-de-corps among officers and soldiers of the NA. While a neat and presentable mufti could be worn during the occasion, social calls could also be made in uniform. However, it is not appropriate to make social calls in sports outfit as it is ungentlemanly to do so.

121. **Calls of Inquiry and Congratulations.** Calls of inquiry are made during the illness or convalescence of a friend or an acquaintance. These calls are also made when the family has experienced some misfortune. The aim of such calls is to serve as an expression of genuine sympathy and friendship. When officers or soldiers are promoted or blessed with a child or other occasion for celebration, it is customary for their colleagues to visit them. On such occasions, cards or gifts might be exchanged.

122. **Calls of Condolence.** A formal call of condolence is made after a funeral. Tact is to be used to avoid causing grief to the bereaved family. Conversation about the bereavement should be avoided unless the family themselves talk of the loss. A tactful way to greet the bereaved person is to say 'I have called to assure

you of my sympathy'. Calls of condolence must be brief Basically, such condolence should be done through the appropriate chain of command.

123. **Cosmetics and Jewellery**. Gentlemen do not go around highly scented or with powder puff marks on the face, neck or ears. It is improper also for officers or soldiers to wear beads, bangles, or chains while in uniform.

124. **Riding on Horse Back**. It is a well-known custom for army officers to ride on horseback especially officers of Guards Brigade and Adjutants of Nigerian Defence Academy during parades. Officers are to develop interest in horse riding as they may find themselves in these units.

125. **Riding Through the Quarter Guard**. Cars, motorbikes and bicycles may be ridden through the quarter guard gate by personnel and visitors. They would be stopped only when that is necessary for routine security checks.

126. **Driving Military Vehicles by Officers/Soldiers**. Military vehicles are expected to be driven by assigned drivers. However, officers and soldiers may drive military vehicles on the following occasions:

- a. During emergency or after an accident where the driver becomes incapacitated.
- b. If the driver suddenly becomes indisposed or falls casualty.
- c. During operations, when they are so permitted.
- d. Where lives need to be saved.

127. **Tempo Day**. The tempo day is a day set aside in units/regiments for doubling within the office area during the duration of working hours. Movement that day from point A to B is by doubling. Units are at liberty to designate tempo day so long it is not more than once in a month. Units are also at liberty to introduce customs/traditions that add to the effectiveness and agility of the personnel.

128. **Carrying of Umbrella**. It is unmilitary for an officer or a soldier to carry umbrella in uniform. Officers and soldiers are to use rain coats and poncho capes respectively.

129. **Nigerian Army Social Activity**. The NA Social Activity (NASA) formerly West African Social Activity (WASA) is an accepted practice of getting officers and soldiers' families together in a social and conducive atmosphere to mark the end of the year. The origin of WASA may be linked to the period of West African Frontier Force, when persons in the society whose ancestral background has some traditional or customary heritage started joining the army. Sacrifices were usually offered at the end of harvest/beginning of planting season to their gods and ancestors for bounty harvest or for peaceful and progressive period in the New Year. Delegates were usually sent to military authority by the village head to seek the release of soldiers for this yearly ritual. Rather than releasing soldiers yearly to perform the ritual, the military authority then, incorporated it in the army activities and tagged it WASA. This traditional ritual included burning of sacrifices, dancing and exposure of masquerades. The colonial masters upheld this tradition in the army to command the confidence of soldiers and to foster esprit-de-corps among them. NASA has come to stay as an annual or seasonal event all over the NA. All Formations and Units Commanders are to ensure that this event is carried out yearly as a means of bringing the families of officers and soldiers together to celebrate the end of the year and to usher in the activities of the New Year.



130. **Designation of Retired Personnel.** All retired officers from Captain and above are to use their rank after their name for example, Capt Musa (rtd). Second Lieutenants and Lieutenants are not to insert (rtd) after their names as they are not entitled to it. This is because judging from their length of service, i.e. the number of years it took to attain their ranks, they have not put in up to 10 years in service. For this reason, they have not attained the years of retirement and therefore are not entitled to it. For soldiers, those who discharged from service are to insert 'ex' before their names, for example, ex-Sgt Kolade.

131. **Dining - In.**

a. The dining-in is a formal dinner function for members of a military organization. The practice of dining-in is believed to have originated in the monasteries and early universities in England.

b. The dining-in provides an occasion for the officers of a unit to meet socially. It may be used as an opportunity to welcome new officers, to bid farewell to departing officers, to honour distinguished visitors, or merely as a chance for officers of the unit to get together socially as a means of building unit esprit-de-corps. The dining-in is to be viewed as an opportunity to enjoy the comradeship of fellow officers rather than as mandatory function.

c. Careful and detailed planning are required to ensure that the occasion proceeds smoothly. The details of the dining-in vary according to its purpose, but those details must be thought through in advance. Formal invitations generally are in order. They are to be sent far enough in advance to elicit formal response so that firm planning can

proceed. The dinner menu may consist of 3 to 7 courses. Toasts are considered a mandatory part of the dining-in. Activities generally are divided into a pre-dinner, social period with cocktails, the formal dinner and an informal dinner period following the formal activities.

d. The formal portion of the dining-in includes the posting of the colours, an innovation if desired, appropriate toasts, introduction of guests, a toast to the guests, dinner service, conduct of the events of the evening, concluding remarks by the presiding officer, retirement of the colour and adjournment to the informal period.

### 132. **Reception of New Officer.**

a. It is necessary to receive a new officer cordially and many acts of courtesy extended to him and his family to make their arrival more pleasant and convenient. It is taken for granted that an officer posted-in knows his professional duties and has every intention of performing them to the best of his ability.

b. Whenever such situation arises, the adjutant is to send a letter of welcome to the newly posted in officer, with information on local conditions that may be important or interesting for the officer to know before arrival. If the arrival is by train or plane, transportation may be arranged to be at the station or airport to meet the new officer.

c. Some stations or units may choose to welcome the new officer and his family through the sponsor system under which the officers on the ground act as hosts and advisers to the new officer and his family. This way, officers would make more enduring friendship among themselves. Certainly, the warm welcome and

thoughtfulness would go a long way to make the new officer gain the good start. In a regiment or unit, the adjutant usually introduces the new officer to the Commanding Officer and at first assembly, to the other officers in the unit. It is also the responsibility of the adjutant to inform the new officer of the local regulations and customs that would be needed immediately and a copy of the unit standing orders made available to him.

133. **Receiving Officers From Sister Services.** Officers of the NA must accord a high degree of cordiality and hospitality to visiting officers from sister Services, the Navy and the Airforce. This includes provision of quarters, invitation to use officers mess, extension of club privileges and social invitation. It also includes, above all, the hand of fellowship and comradeship to stimulate a feeling of togetherness and sound cooperation of the Services.

134. **Farewell to a Posted Officer.** Prior to the departure of an officer from his unit or station on change of assignment, a reception, or other suitable function is usually given in honour of the departing officer and family. Often one of the unit social functions is used for this purpose.

135. **Departing before a Commander.** Officers must remain at a reception or social gathering until the Commander or Commanding Officer has departed. On no account will an officer leave a social gathering before his commander unless there is cogent reason to do so, in which case he must obtain permission from the Commander.

136. **Place of Honour.** The place of honour is to the right. Accordingly, when a subordinate officer walks, rides or sits with a superior, the subordinate must take position to the left of his

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senior. The subordinate is to walk in step with the superior, step back and allow the superior to be the first to use the door. When 2 subordinate officers are walking with a superior officer, they are to flank the superior officer, but the one to the right must make room for the superior officer to take salute appropriately.

## **SECTION 4**

### **ETHICS**

137. Ethics are moral principles that influence or control a person's behaviour within a group. The adjective 'ethical' refers to what is morally correct or honourable and therefore generally acceptable. The peculiar nature of the military profession makes it imperative that a uniform ethical code of conduct be laid down for military personnel to observe as a matter of duty. This would reduce doubts as to the appropriateness of behaviour and ensure a high standard of uniform conduct on the part of NA officers and soldiers.

138. The ethics of the NA is categorized into 3 broad groups: the ethics in relation to the soldier's status as a citizen and government employee, the ethics of the military profession and war ethics. It is worthy of note that due to the legal status of an officer or soldier, which is known as the doctrine of compact and which sees the military personnel first as a citizen and then as a soldier, military personnel are bound by both civil and military laws. The obvious implication of this status is that personnel are reasonably expected to observe 2 sets of ethical codes of conduct, that is, the ethics applicable to civil servants as government employees and those peculiar to the military profession.

### **ETHICS IN RELATION TO STATUS AS A CITIZEN AND GOVERNMENT EMPLOYEE**

139. The ethics in relation to the soldier's status as a citizen and government employee refer to the general code of conduct that defines the relationship between government employees and the government. They concern such issues as employee's duty to

government in the employment relationship, emphasizing loyalty to government and dedication to duty. NA officers and soldiers are government employees and must therefore observe these ethics ever conscious of the incontrovertible fact that public offices are held on public trust.

140. **Loyalty.**

a. Military personnel will show and demonstrate absolute loyalty to the country and uphold the constitution, laws and regulations of the Federal Republic of Nigeria. They will not use any official information available to them due to their positions and responsibilities as public officers as a means of making private gains.

b. All officers and soldiers of the NA will give a full day's labour for a full day's pay by applying earnest effort and best thought to the performance of their duties. They will seek and employ efficient and economic ways of getting tasks accomplished.

141. **Integrity.**

a. **Conduct Prejudicial to the Government.** Military personnel shall not engage in criminal, infamous, dishonest, immoral or disgraceful conduct, or other conducts prejudicial to the government. Moreover, military personnel shall avoid any action whether or not specifically prohibited by this part, which might result in or create the appearance of:

- (1) Using public office for private gains.
- (2) Giving preferential treatment to any person.
- (3) Losing complete independence or impartiality.

- (4) Impeding government efficiency or economy.
- (5) Making a government decision outside official channel.
- (6) Affecting adversely the confidence of the public as to the integrity of the government.

b. **Corruption.** Corruption refers to dishonest or illegal behaviour such as bribery and gratification, especially by those in advantaged position. It is therefore unethical for the soldier to be involved in any act of corruption.

c. **Bribery.** Bribery is the act or practice of offering and taking some favour in cash or kind to persuade someone to do something illegal, improper or behave in certain way. Bribery is illegal, ungentlemanly and demanding, taking and giving it must therefore be avoided by all NA personnel.

d. **Gratification.** Military personnel will not solicit or accept any gift, gratitude, favour, entertainment, loan or any other thing of value either directly or indirectly from any person, firm, corporation or other entity which:

- (1) Is engaged or is endeavouring to engage in procurement activities, business or financial transaction of any sort with any agency of the Ministry of Defence or the NA.
- (2) Conducts operations or activities that are regulated by an agency of the Ministry of Defence.
- (3) Has interest that may be substantially affected by the performance or non-performance of the official duty.

Gifts, gratitude, favour, entertainments, bestowed upon members of the immediate families of military personnel are viewed in the same light as those bestowed upon military personnel. Acceptance of gifts, gratitude, favour, entertainment, etc, no matter how innocently tendered and received, from those who have or seek business with the Ministry of Defence may be a source of embarrassment to the Ministry and the personnel involved, may affect the objective judgement of the recipient and impair public confidence in the integrity of the Ministry of Defence. NA officers and soldiers will adhere to all prevailing government regulations on gifts and acceptance of gifts. For the purpose of this section, a gift, gratitude, favour, entertainment, include any tangible item, intangible benefits, discounts, tickets, passes, transportation, accommodation or hospitality given or extended to the recipient. However, the restrictions do not apply to the following:

- (1) Instance where the interest of the government is served by participation of military personnel in widely attended luncheons, dinners, and similar gatherings sponsored by industrial, technical and professional associations for the discussion of matters of mutual interest to Government and industry.
- (2) Acceptance of advertising items of trivial intrinsic value.
- (3) Customary exchange of social amenities between personal friends and relatives when motivated by such relationship and extended on personal basis.



(4) Taking part or benefiting from things available to the general public such as free exhibitions.

(5) Acceptance of trophies, entertainment, rewards or prizes given to competitors in contests which are open to the public which are officially approved for participation by military personnel.

(6) The acceptance of loans from banks or other financial institutions on customary terms to finance projects and usual activities of employees such as home mortgage loans.

(7) Social activities engaged in by officials of the Ministry of Defence and officers in command or their representatives with local civilian leaders as part of community programme.

(8) Receipts of bonafide reimbursement, not prohibited by law or approved by MOD, eg reimbursement from contractor for actual expenses for a trip and other necessary subsistence for which no government payment or reimbursement is made.

142. **Efficiency.** NA personnel must be prudent in the use of government facilities, properties and manpower. They will not directly or indirectly use, or allow the use of government property, including property leased to the government, for other than officially approved activities. Government facilities, properties and manpower, such as stenographic and typing assistance, and chauffeur services, may be used only for official government business. Military personnel have positive duty to protect and conserve government property entrusted to them. This section is not intended to preclude the use of government facilities for activities, which would further military- community relations provided they do not interfere with military missions.

143. **Dedicated Service.**

a. **Private Practice.**

(1) Military personnel are bound to refrain from any private business or professional activity or from having any direct or indirect financial interest which would place them in a position where there will be conflict between their private interests and the public interest of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, particularly those related to their duties and responsibilities as military personnel.

(2) Military personnel will not engage in any private business or professional activity, or enter into any financial transaction which involves the direct or indirect use, or the appearance of use of inside information for private gain for them or another person or entity, especially those persons or entities with whom or which they have family business or financial ties.

(3) For the purpose of this section, insider information means information obtained under government authority, which has not become part of the body of public information. This section does not preclude military personnel from having financial interest or engaging in financial transaction to the same extent as private citizens not employed by the government so long as they are not prohibited by law.

(4) No member of the Armed Forces may be ordered or permitted to leave his post to engage in a civil pursuit or business, or a performance in civil life for

emolument if the pursuit, business, or performance interferes with the customary or regular employment.

b. **Employment Outside Military.** NA personnel shall not concurrently engage in employment other than the military which interferes with, or is incompatible with the performance of official duties. They will also not engage in any employment that may reasonably be expected to bring discredit to the Government or Ministry of Defence. However, the above provisions do not preclude the involvement of NA personnel in extra regimental appointments, committees and other officially approved duties in pursuit of government interest.

c. **Membership of Associations.** NA personnel who are members of professional associations must formally declare their membership in writing to the ASA. All military personnel who are members or officers of non-governmental association or organizations must avoid participating in activities on behalf of the association or organization that are incompatible with official government positions. They are to relinquish their membership of such associations if their position and responsibilities are in conflict with their position as government employees.

d. **Acceptance and use of Titles.** Officers and soldiers of the NA must obtain the written permission of the COAS before accepting any title bestowed on them by non military institutions such as traditional, religious and social titles. Military personnel on active service are prohibited from using their civilian and military titles or positions in connection with any commercial enterprises or in endorsing any commercial product. However, all retired

military personnel and all members of NA reserve components, not on active service are permitted to use their military titles in connection with commercial enterprises. Such use of the military titles shall in no way cause discredit to the military service or the Ministry of Defence.

e. **Employment by Other Governments and Organizations.** Service personnel will not be employed under any government other than that of Nigeria, except when such employment has been sanctioned by the appropriate authority. A Service personnel who leaves the active list must not, so long as he continues to hold a commission or to draw retired pay, enter the service of any government outside Nigeria, any organization sponsored by such a government, or any international organization without the consent of the NA Council.

## **ETHICS IN RELATION TO THE MILITARY PROFESSION**

144. The military profession like other professions has behavioural patterns and a code of conduct which guides its personnel in the conduct of their professional duties. Ethics of NA are the 'Dos' and 'Don'ts' in military life which culminate to the display of high standard of discipline. The strict observance of these ethics is an important factor in the maintenance of discipline and absolute loyalty to the NA.

145. **Loyalty.** Service personnel must be loyal to the Army, their corps, regiments/units and their families. They must not run down the military establishments to hearing of outsiders. There is no half measure to loyalty.

a. **The Army.** Be careful not to ridicule the Army in the

presence of civilians. Do not pass cynical comments on superior officers and authority. Esprit-de-corps should be maintained.

b. **Protection of Image of Other Units.** Personnel are to also protect the good image of other units as their own. Give courtesy to other regiments and do not run them down.

c. **Abuse of the Soldier.** A Service personnel must not use abusive language on his subordinates or employ them in a manner that dishonours them. Mutual respect must exist in all aspect of their relationship.

d. **Respect for One's and Other's Families.** Service personnel are to respect their families. A man or woman should be a partner at home to the wife or husband and not a dictator. There must be mutual respect and concern between and amongst families. It is an offence to have amorous relationship with the wives, husbands, daughters, sons or wards of fellow Service personnel. Fighting or any form of violence must be avoided within and outside the family.

146. **Service Knowledge and Intellectual Development.** It is important for the officer or soldier to take particular interest in current affairs and general developments in the immediate and global environments. Officers and soldiers must be enlightened and in turn enlighten the personnel under them. They must keep abreast with local and international military and political situations through the electronic and print media. An officer or soldier must strive at self-development; especially in areas of current global interest such as computer awareness and technology. They must also take interest in contributing to military journals and magazines.

**147. Behaviour and Conduct.**

a. A Service personnel's behaviour must be exemplary wherever he finds himself. Polite behaviour of a gentleman is what is required of him. He should be friendly and considerate but careful and firm with all. He should respect his superiors in rank, courteous and just, yet he must not exhibit familiarity. Officers and soldiers are to address their superiors as sir at all times. A superior officer may wish to call his subordinate by his first name, for example, Major John Bukar can be called John by his superior officer. On no account will a subordinate call his superior by his first name. Even when Service personnel are of equal rank, every respect must be accorded to the superior by date. It is an old custom of the service to say 'good morning' or 'good morning, sir' as the case may be to other Service personnel when met for the first time that day. It is for the subordinate to speak first.

b. Service personnel must avoid 'hear say' or rumour peddling. Any doubtful information must be promptly cleared through the appropriate authority.

c. Service personnel will not take alcoholic drink while on duty as this could influence their performance negatively. They will not take any prohibited substances such as hard drugs etc at any time.

**148. Dress Appearance and Carriage.** The standard of dressing and appearance of service personnel determine in part the level of discipline. Service personnel must therefore be smart and well turned out at all times. In using civil clothes, flashy and multifarious coloured materials are to be avoided. Good materials and good tailors will help meet this required standard.

Uniform is to be worn by all ranks while on duty, except when an order to the contrary is given. Civil clothes may be worn when not on duty but to be withdrawn automatically when Service personnel is undergoing punishment of restriction of privileges. On no occasion are personnel allowed to turn out incompletely dressed in uniform as this undermines professionalism and discipline.

149. **Punctuality**. Punctuality is a conspicuous and important aspect of discipline and must be upheld. NA personnel must be punctual at all parades and functions to avoid embarrassment.

150. **Compliments**. Compliments are normally initiated by the subordinate and demand an instant response from the superior. In the NA, subordinates pay compliments to their superiors at all times. Officers and soldiers entering an office will pay compliment irrespective of the rank of the occupant. A subordinate officer must stand up when a senior officer enters his office and must remain standing until he is asked to sit down by the senior officer. Also see Salute in Paragraph 84.

151. **Respect for Chain of Command**. All officers and soldiers must always follow the proper chain of command in all the day to day military engagements. It is unethical to bypass the chain of command.

152. **Restraint from Political Activities**. Serving military personnel are not to participate in the affairs of any political organization or party. All forms of political activities, including political meetings and speeches, are prohibited in the barracks and Service establishments. Information about party programmes or policies is not to be made available through Service journals or information rooms; nor is any propaganda issued by or on behalf of a political party to be distributed in

Service institutions. However, military personnel are allowed to obtain information through print/mass media, exercise their civic rights and to vote for political parties of their choice. They are to be in mufti while exercising their voting rights.

153. **Sanctity of Marriage and Family Life.** The NA respects and recognizes the institution and sanctity of marriage and encourages all NA personnel to uphold it. An officer must introduce his fiancée to, and obtain the permission of his Commander before getting married. Young officers must know that the NA does not officially recognize the marriage of an officer until he or she is 25 years of age and not below the rank of Lieutenant. The reason for this is that a young officer has much to learn before he/she becomes fully proficient. This includes the theoretical, technical and tactical subjects as well as the practical side of soldiering and man- management which are better learnt by being with the men as much as possible, both on and off parade, playing games, or organizing their sports and recreation. If an officer marries too young, he is bound to have distractions occasioned by marital related commitments which might adversely affect his proficiency at the early stages of his military career. A young officer must take into consideration the financial difficulties which he will encounter if he marries too young. An officer is entitled to allocation of married quarters if he/she is married. A young soldier should serve at least 3 years post Depot training in the unit before he/she is allowed to marry.

- a. **Marriage of Officers to Soldiers.** If an officer and a soldier in Service wish to be married, either of them must relinquish his/her commission or discharge from the Army respectively before the marriage. This is to foster discipline. A female officer who wishes to be married to a soldier must relinquish her commission or the soldier must first discharge from the Army.



b. **Marriage of Female Personnel to Civilians.** All female personnel married to civilians may wish to live with their civilian husbands in the barracks provided they abide by the rules and regulations concerning barracks life. The offspring of the marriage is also entitled to all benefits just as the offspring of their male counterparts. This is to avoid breach of security in the barracks.

c. **Marriage to Foreigners.** Officers and soldiers are not allowed to marry foreigners except for those that were already married to them before 1975. An officer or soldier who wishes to marry a foreigner must relinquish his commission or discharge from the Army as the case may be.

154. **Sanctity of Parade Ground.** Smoking while on the parade ground or walking across it in civil clothes is prohibited. Never interrupt a parade by walking between the parade and its commander even if you are senior to all ranks on parade.

155. **Financial Matters.**

a. **Indebtedness.** Military personnel shall pay all just financial obligations in proper and timely manner, especially those imposed by law such as Federal, State or Local taxes or rates, mess bills etc.

b. **Savings.** All NA personnel are encouraged to imbibe the culture of saving and to put aside at least some reasonable percentage of their income as savings monthly. They are also advised to take advantage of available facilities such as mortgage schemes and insurance.

c. **Insolvency.** It is decent to live within one's means. Every personnel must be able to regularize his expenditure

to avoid being 'hard up'. All Service personnel are to refrain from lending and borrowing money. Should such situation genuinely occur, they must consult their units or commanders. It is forbidden for officers and soldiers to engage in money lending for profit or borrowing beyond their financial ability to pay. A soldier in financial embarrassment is a security risk to the Army and to the Nation as he can easily be compromised. Failure to live within one's mean can lead one to bankruptcy and must be avoided.

d. **Public Funds**. A Service personnel has responsibility for the funds in his care. He must ensure safekeeping of the funds and make good any deficiencies. He must keep accurate records of financial transactions and present them for audit when required.

e. **Private Accounts**. Every personnel should keep records of their private accounts, by copies of evidence of their financial transactions. They should always ask for their monthly statement from their bankers.

f. **Dud Cheque**. It is dishonesty to write a cheque above the amount one has in the bank without prior clearance. All Service personnel must avoid issuing dud cheque for it may lead to court martial.

g. **Mess Contributions, Subscriptions and Accountability**. Mess members are to contribute in financing the mess. All mess bills and subscriptions must be settled promptly to allow the mess to run smoothly. It is a discredit to an officer or a Senior Non-Commissioned Officer to refuse to pay mess subscriptions as at when due. Those who handle the mess funds must be prudent, honest

and accountable. Embezzlement of the mess fund must be avoided.

h. **Cash and Valuables.** Service personnel must never leave money or valuable items lying carelessly in their quarters, room or office. They must always secure their property adequately.

i. **Receipts.** When an officer or a soldier hands over any money or stores, he must always obtain receipt. Receipts of any money must always be acknowledged. Letters about money matters must be replied promptly.

156. **Religion.** The reverent observance of religion in the Army is very important. In the light of the above, the NA allows controlled freedom of worship. There are 3 centres of religious worship in the barracks. These are the Protestant Churches and Roman Catholic Churches of the Christian faith as well as Mosques for Muslims. All military personnel are expected to worship in any of the 3 centres. Holding of any form of public worship outside these 3 centres in the barracks is not allowed. It is the duty of all Commanders to make adequate provision for the spiritual and moral needs of their personnel.

157. **Declaration of Religion.**

a. On entry to the Service, every member of the NA is to be asked to declare, with complete freedom, his religion. This is well documented and endorsed by himself.

b. The freedom is extended to change of religion without rancour. It only demands that when a Service personnel wishes to change his religion he is to notify his Commander. The Commander is to inform the Chaplain or

the Imam concerned to confirm the individual's willingness to make the change and any necessary religious instructions given. The personnel's documents are amended when it is satisfied that the individual has decided willingly to make the change and is fully aware of the significance of his action.

c. The same freedom is also extended to the personnel's families residing in the barracks but must be with the consent of the Service personnel.

d. **Padre Hour.** Padre hour is a religious obligation and will be observed by all on Fridays from 1200 hrs. It is a parade that must be observed by all.

158. **Manners.**

a. **Utterance and Sounding Off.** Good manners are determined through people's utterances. A good Service personnel does not talk frivolously and must be careful with what he says. He must talk less, listen more and see most. Service personnel must watch their public utterances.

b. **Exhibitionism.** Exhibitionism means drawing attention to oneself in public place for example through shouting, whistling and loud laughter. These are acts of bad manners that must be avoided.

c. **Apologies.** Apologies at appropriate times show good manners. For instance, if you interrupt a speaker, you should say 'I am sorry'. All Service personnel must endeavour to apologize when there is breach of etiquette occasioned by their own action or inaction. However, apologise only when you are manifestly wrong.

d. **Keeping Bad Company.** Officers and soldiers must not be seen in a company of men of questionable character as they are assessed by the type of company they keep. Military personnel are men of honour and integrity and as such they must strive to maintain good image for the military by avoiding bad company.

e. **Pocketing.** Pocketing one's hands in uniform does not portray one as disciplined. It makes the officer or soldier look arrogant. It is a slight and disrespect to address troops with hands in your pocket.

f. **Lying.** This is a dishonest act punishable by law. The image of the liar is tarnished and it is difficult to know when he tells the truth. A liar is prone to any other type of misconduct such as stealing, adultery, etc. All military personnel must avoid telling lies.

g. **Hand Shake.** The superior will initiate hand shake with the subordinates by stretching out his hand first. The subordinate will respectfully accept the hand in a gentlemanly manner. The subordinate will not slap the superior's hand nor squeeze it in an un-gentlemanly manner.

159. **Courtesy and Etiquettes in the Workplace.** The worst thing you can do to any organization is to portray it as not having personnel with good manners. Officers and soldiers of the NA should therefore endeavour to observe the following work ethics:

a. Never sit with your feet on your work desk as this gives visitors a bad impression of the formation/unit.

## RESTRICTED

b. When a superior who is not your immediate superior enters your office, you are obliged to stand up until asked to sit down. If you cannot stand up, for example if you are on telephone, indicate by a nod of the head or a gesture with a free hand that the visitor may be seated.

c. Never keep somebody standing in your office unnecessarily unless he or she is there on disciplinary ground.

d. If refreshment is available, such as coffee or tea, offer your visitor.

e. Never lean or sit on someone's table while talking to him. If a superior you are visiting does not offer you a seat, remain standing. To lean or sit on another person's desk presumes a degree of familiarity with the person that should never be displayed in public.

f. Consider that a visit in person takes precedence over a telephone call. If you happen to be on phone when a guest or visitor arrives, beckon him to sit down and finish your conversation as quickly as possible or excuse yourself and call the other party back later.

g. Never spit in the waste paper basket nor deposit unfinished fruit or sandwiches in the waste paper basket.

h. It is best not to eat in your office. Many people believe that because of the pressure of work they must eat in the office but there are also good reasons for not doing so under normal conditions. It is inappropriate to eat in your office. Your office is meant for working and not eating. Give yourself a break no matter how busy you think you may be, you can always find a few minutes to step outside your

work area, find a quiet spot and eat your lunch. Formations and units must create and publish timings for break.

i. Be tolerant of your co-workers. Regard them as members of the team who also contribute to the achievement of your corporate goals. A subordinate should not be kept standing for too long if he has a job to do with his superior in the superior's office or when he seeks and is granted the superior's interview. Create a cordial atmosphere in your office by allowing the subordinate to sit down as it is not disrespectful for him to do so with your permission.

j. Set examples for others to emulate. If you encounter someone you dislike, suppress your intolerance. Allowing other people to annoy you is evidence of your own lack of self-discipline.

160. **Courtesy and Etiquettes in the Use of Phones.**

a. Most military personnel have more contact with the public on the telephone than anywhere else. This is particularly true of officers and soldiers who serve in major military establishments. It is essential that proper telephone courtesy is observed at all times because failure to do so would give callers wrong impression of your unit or formation.

b. Basically, identify your unit or office, and then your name. Do not bother the caller with a deluge of acronyms or a long recitation of your chain of command. If you are in 'A' Company orderly room, answer, 'Alpha Company Orderly Room', Sgt Okoro speaking Sir'. Do not shout into the telephone or speak as if you are giving a command on

the drill square. Use the 'Sir' as appropriate as it is a mark of respect. Pay attention to the callers own rank and name and use them wherever appropriate during conversation. If the person being called is not in, offer to take a message or refer the caller to another party who may be able to help. Listen patiently and respond politely. Many people who ask for information do not know what they want and sometimes you have to help them to phrase their questions. Above all, speak distinctly and with confidence. Some people answer the telephone as if they do not really know who they are and this gives very bad impression of the organization they represent. Do not tie down the telephone in long personal conversation. Should you dial a wrong number, never just hang up without saying anything, excuse yourself of the interruption and check the number you have dialed. Never allow the telephone to ring more than 3 times without picking. NA personnel must not use a mobile phone, ear piece/ear pod/head set while on uniform or duty for any reason. This is act considered disrespectful and inappropriate.

c. **Use of Mobile Phones.** Mobile phones will be switched off during conferences, parades and other official gatherings where leaving them on might result in distraction of the official assignment. Subordinates will switch off their phones before entering a senior's office as distractions from the phone will portray lack of courtesy.

161. **Etiquette in the Use of Internet and Social Media.** The Internet and social media have gained popularity globally in recent times. Personnel of the NA and indeed the Armed Forces of Nigeria (AFN) use the Internet and social media for communication, interaction and information acquisition. While the Internet and social media are viable tools for information



exchange, it is imperative for all NA personnel to ensure that the platforms are used professionally and responsibly. In this regard, all personnel have the responsibility to at all times ensure strict adherence to the provisions of the Policy on the Use of Social Media for the Armed Forces of Nigeria.

162. **Courtesy and Etiquette as a Guest**. Many times during your career you will be invited to stay with people when you are travelling. You should always be appreciative when others open their homes to you and you should do your best to be a courteous guest during your stay. The main points to remember are:

- a. When staying with someone else, you should conform to the habits of that household by keeping the same meal hours, going to bed and rising the same time as they do.
- b. Unless you are specifically invited to stay for a certain number of days, make your stay as short as possible.
- c. Be sure to acquaint your host with your departure plans and leave on time.
- d. If you dine with the family, be punctual at meal time.
- e. Keep your room neat always, make your bed everyday and be sure that the bathroom is kept tidy after use.
- f. If you are the host, never let your guest take public transportation when you can provide, but drive the guest to the nearest terminal.
- g. Show appreciation for the good gesture of your host by verbally expressing your gratitude. This could be reinforced with souvenirs where possible.

h. It is appropriate to give souvenirs to visitors to your unit or formation whether in Nigeria or while operating abroad. Individual officers and soldiers attending courses in foreign institutions could give Nigerian souvenirs to their respective faculty members and colleagues.

163. **Always an Ambassador**. To maintain good international relations, Nigeria exchanges foreign missions at ambassadorial and military attaché levels. NA personnel employed to foreign missions must be good ambassadors of the Service and the country. Actions, attitude and conduct of all soldiers on routine duties or on operations leave an impression on the Army and the country. They must therefore see themselves as ambassadors always.

## **WAR ETHICS**

164. NA personnel must comply with the Laws of Armed Conflict and other regulations applicable wherever and whenever they are on operations or war. The care for the prisoners of war is the responsibility of both the government whose forces capture them and the individual members of such forces. From the moment of capture, prisoners of war are to be treated in accordance with the requirements of the Laws of Armed Conflicts. All persons who have prisoners of war in their charge are to ensure that:

- a. They are treated humanely and that the wounded and sick are cared for as far as the exigencies of the situation and the need for security allow.
- b. They must be protected as far as possible from danger and removed from the area of immediate hostilities as soon as possible.

165. **Combat Rules.**

- a. Fight only combatants.
- b. Attack only military targets.
- c. Spare civilian persons and objects.
- d. Restrict destruction to what your mission requires.

166. **Enemy Combatants who Surrender.** For all combatant enemies who surrender, you:

- a. Spare them.
- b. Disarm them.
- c. Treat them humanely and protect them.
- d. May question them, but they are only bound to give information for their personal identification.
- e. Hand them over to your superior for evacuation to the rear.

167. **Dead and Wounded Enemy Combatants.** You should:

- a. Collect them.
- b. Treat and care for them.
- c. Hand them over to your superior or the nearest medical centre.
- d. In case of death, full burial honours should be given to Service personnel.

168. **Civilian**. When civilian enemies fall into your hand:

- a. Respect them.
- b. Treat them humanely.
- c. Protect them against ill treatment; vengeance and taking of hostage are prohibited.
- d. Respect their property, do not damage or steal them.
- e. Enemy civilians may not be compelled to give information.

169. **Distinctive Signs**. Distinctive Signs mark areas reserved for specific purposes for the benefit of all, for example, the Red Cross. It is imperative that you:

- a. Respect persons bearing an object with such signs.
- b. Co-operate with NGOs to perform their tasks unless ordered otherwise.

Details of War Ethics are contained in Laws of Armed Conflicts.

## **CODE OF CONDUCT**

170. The NA has proudly served in many missions at home and abroad and endeared itself to the international community and the Nigerian people by its resilience, endurance and ability to attain its objectives despite all odds. There is a need to sustain this credibility by holding our core values through the observance of our time honoured traditions, customs and ethics. This is best gauged in the conduct of officers and soldiers.

171. **Standards of Conduct**. Within the close-knit and mutually supporting military community, the consequences of loss of trust are potentially severe. This underscores the need to

lay down standard of conduct expected of Service personnel. It is therefore necessary for Service personnel to understand and adhere to the standards below:

- a. **The Service Test.** Service test is the acceptable standard of evaluation of Service personnel behaviour in the performance of military duty. Commanders at all levels must consider each case on its merit against the following Service test: “Have the actions or behaviour of an individual adversely impacted or are they likely to impact on the efficiency or operational effectiveness of the Army”. This Service Test lies at the heart of the Armed Forces Act which stipulates offences and punishment for any breach of conduct.
- b. **Adherence to the Law.** All Service personnel are subject to Military Law, Civil Law and Laws of Armed Conflict which they have a duty to uphold. Moreover, civil offences have been fully brought within the Military law under Sections 104 - 114 of the Armed Forces Act CAP A20 2004. In addition, when deployed on operations, Service personnel are subject to the Laws of Armed Conflict and to the local law wherever they are serving. Military Law, the Civil Law, and the Laws of Armed Conflict establish the baseline for the standards of conduct of Service personnel. It is therefore appropriate that the NA insists upon standards of conduct that are in some respects more demanding than those which obtain generally in the civil society.
- c. **Adherence to Ethos and Values.** The profession of arms involves the disciplined use of legally *sanctioned* force. It imposes many demands but imparts lasting rewards upon those who enter into it. The NA is a voluntary

Army. While the professional calling of Service personnel is to support and defend the Nigerian Constitution and our territorial integrity, the challenge is to learn the profession well enough to accomplish any mission with honour and pride.

d. **Cooperation with Sister Services.** The NA cannot accomplish all its constitutional roles without the cooperation of other Services. Officers and soldiers of the NA must respect the roles of these Services as this will guarantee the capacity to collectively defend the Nigerian Constitution and territorial integrity.

e. **Adherence to Oaths.** Officers on commission take an oath of allegiance to the President, Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces as well as make a commitment to uphold the Nigerian Constitution while soldiers do same on attestation. All officers and soldiers must therefore obey all lawful orders passed down to them by their superiors in adherence to the oath they took. These are fundamental obligations of every personnel in the NA.

f. **Will to Win.** The ‘will to win’ is developed and sustained through discipline, realistic training, commitment to Army values and pride in the Army heritage. It demands continual development, learning new skills and preparation to lead and be led. All service personnel must develop the ‘will to win’ as a basic requirement in all endeavours.

g. **Accomplishment of Mission.** No mission is too difficult, no sacrifice is too great, each Service personnel has an important job to do, necessary to the overall mission. Soldiers fight for each other and would rather die than let

their commanders down. Such loyalty and respect run from leaders to subordinates, among colleagues as well as from subordinates to leaders. Mutual support marks our own culture. We must always complete the missions to the best of our ability.

h. **Dedication to Duty.** A good soldier never gives up on his commanders and never compromises his duty. A good commander will not abandon his soldiers except if doing otherwise will jeopardize the mission. Dedication to duty requires unrelenting respect and consistent determination to do what is right with pride. Understanding what is right requires respect for both comrades and commanders and in all cases there must be collective commitment to win with honour. All Service personnel must therefore demonstrate the highest level of dedication to duty.

172. **Taboos.** The following are taboos:

I. **Discrimination and Harassment.** All Service personnel have the right to live and work in an environment free from harassment, discrimination and intimidation. Service personnel must not harass, discriminate or intimidate any person.

j. **Bullying.** Bullying involves forcing other people to do things against their wish. It entails the use of physical strength or the abuse of authority to intimidate or victimize others or to give unlawful punishment. Bullying is unacceptable behaviour which will undermine trust and respect. It is the responsibility of commanders to protect others from physical and mental bullying and to report any incident promptly. Similarly, initiation practices involving assault, humiliation, intimidation and abuse of alcohol are

not to be tolerated. Regimental customs must not involve any form of abuse.

k. **Social Conduct.** Service personnel must not sexually abuse subordinates. Amorous relationships with the spouses and dependents of officers and soldiers in any form are not allowed. They must not physically or verbally abuse or assault others.

l. **Religious Intolerance.** Service personnel must tolerate and respect each other's faith.

m. **Drug and Alcohol Abuse.** Like in the last society, the NA frowns seriously at drugs and alcohol misuse. Those involved in them are a liability not only to themselves but also to the group. Their judgement may be impaired, their fitness reduced and health damaged. Drugs and alcohol are also a major cause of indiscipline. Personnel under the influence of drugs and alcohol cannot be relied upon to perform their duties competently as they can put their own lives and those of others at risk. Service personnel must not be involved in drug and alcohol abuse. Unless special permission is given by appropriate superior authority, alcohol will only be sold in the messes and soldiers' club.

n. **Homosexuality.** Homosexuality is an amorous relationship between persons of the same sex. It is unlawful for an officer or soldier to be engaged in such act, conceal or encourage it notwithstanding the applicable laws where the officer or soldier is located at the time of the act.

o. **Lesbianism.** Lesbianism is an amorous relationship between females. It is unlawful for a female officer or soldier to be engaged in such act, even if the laws applicable



where she committed the alleged act do not consider the act unlawful.

p. **Bestiality**. It is unnatural and unlawful for an officer or soldier to have sexual intercourse with an animal.

q. **Sexual Exploitation and Abuse**. Any act relating to the abuse of a person in a position of vulnerability for sexual purposes is prohibited in the NA. It is also forbidden to sexually exploit for the purpose of profiting monetarily, socially, or politically or any other reason.

r. **Irresponsible Indebtedness**. All Service personnel must manage their debts responsibly and must not allow such debts to reach an overwhelming scale. Unmanageable or otherwise irresponsible indebtedness amounts to indiscipline and therefore should be avoided by all Service personnel.

s. **Utterances and Sounding Off**. All Service personnel must watch public utterances and avoid sounding off or boasting.

t. **Rumour Peddling**. Rumour peddling is dangerous to the trust within the formation, regiment or unit. Service personnel must avoid 'hear say' or rumour peddling. Any doubtful information is to be promptly cleared with the appropriate authority.

u. **Smoking**. Service personnel must adhere to rules and regulations guiding smoking.

v. **Exhibitionism**. All acts of exhibitionism such as shouting, whistling and loud laughter must be avoided by all Service personnel.

w. **Keeping Bad Company.** We are assessed by the type of company we keep. Officers and soldiers must not be seen in company of men of questionable character.

x. **Cult and Secret Societies.** Service personnel are forbidden from associating with or being members of cult and secret societies.

y. **Gambling.** All forms of gambling are forbidden in the barracks except those organized as part of social functions.

z. **Lying.** Lying is a dishonest act. All military personnel must therefore avoid telling lies in any form.

aa. **Dud Cheque.** Service personnel must not overdraw their accounts or issue dud cheque.

ab. **Indecent Exposure.** Service personnel must avoid any form of indecent exposure.

ac. **Reckless Driving.** Service personnel either in Service or personal vehicles must avoid reckless driving and driving under the influence of alcohol.

ad. **Inscription of Body Tattoo.** The use of body tattoo is prohibited in the NA and viewed as disregard to professionalism and Service discipline.

ae. **Other Unacceptable Behaviours.** It is not possible to list all unacceptable behaviours. However, any behaviour that damages trust, degrades an individual, undermines respect for authority or brings the NA to disrepute are not to be tolerated.

**SECTION 5**

**SUMMARY CODE OF ETHICS FOR THE NIGERIAN  
ARMY**

173. The ethical standard of conduct expected of every officer and soldier has been summarized as follows:

- a. Put loyalty to the highest moral principles and put the country above loyalty to persons, party or government department.
- b. Uphold the Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, all applicable laws and regulations.
- c. Give a full day's job for a full day's pay; give your earnest effort and best thought to the performance of your duties.
- d. Find efficient and economical ways of getting tasks accomplished.
- e. Never discriminate in the dispensation of special favours or privileges to anyone, whether for a remuneration or not, and never accept, for yourself or your family, favours or benefits under circumstances which might be construed by reasonable persons as influencing the performance of your official duties.
- f. Make no private promises of any kind binding upon the duties of office, since a government employee has no private word, which can be binding on public duty.
- g. Engage in no business either directly or indirectly,

## RESTRICTED

which is inconsistent with the conscientious performance of your official duties.

h. Never use any information coming to you confidentially in the performance of official duties as a means for making private profit.

i. Do not be involved in any act of corruption and expose corruption whenever discovered.

j. Service personnel are bound to refrain from any private business while still in Service.

k. No Service personnel is allowed to use public office for private gain.

l. In general, military personnel must not solicit, accept or agree to accept or give anything of value in return for performance or refraining from performing official duties.

m. Service personnel will not directly or indirectly use or allow the use of government property for other than officially approved activities.

n. Service personnel will not use their civilian titles while in Service.

o. Service personnel shall not engage in outside employment or outside activity which interfere with, or is not compatible with the performance of their duties.

p. Service personnel shall not participate in gambling activity including the operation of gambling devices, in conducting a lottery or pool except for approved social activities in the unit or establishment.

## RESTRICTED

q. A Service personnel shall not accept inappropriate gifts, favour, entertainments etc from personnel subordinate to him in rank.

r. A Service personnel shall not engage in amorous relationship with any person of the same sex or with the husband, wife or child of Service personnel. A male officer shall not have amorous relationship with a female soldier while a female officer shall not have same with a male soldier.

s. A Service personnel shall pay all just financial obligations in a proper and timely manner especially those imposed by law and mutual contract.

t. A Service personnel shall not hold membership of any secret society, cult organization or political party.

u. A Service personnel shall not engage in any form of brawl or any action of public disgrace.

v. A Service personnel must not at any time be drunk whether on or off duty.

w. Service personnel must care for barracks and accommodation and ensure defects/damage are reported promptly to appropriate authority.

x. Service personnel must not carry out unauthorised alteration to uniform, stores, equipment, vehicles or barracks accommodation and any other belonging of the NA.

y. Observance of the rules within the mess and any other

## RESTRICTED

military establishments and military sponsored association and discipline in them is the responsibility of Service personnel.

z. Every Service personnel must show good manners in and out of uniform, watch his conduct and display a high standard of behaviour.

aa. A Service personnel must be smart and well turned out at all times. His uniform must be as prescribed by the NA Dress Regulations while his appearance is to be decent.

bb. Uniforms are not allowed when participating in non Service parades or at public functions such as during matches and concerts. Uniforms may be allowed when Service personnel are engaged in temporary or part time civil employment.

cc. Service personnel must avoid making public utterances that are inimical to Service interest. They must also avoid rumour mongering and never 'volunteer information' to the media.

dd. Apologize appropriately but avoid making apologies for a lawful order given by yourself or by your superior.

ee. In uniform, soldiers are not to smoke when moving on foot from one point to other. Control your smoking habit and do not smoke on parade ground, in any public place or office with head gear on and out-door when in uniform except when seated.

ff. Service personnel must watch their conduct in public places and give considerations to co-users of public utilities/facilities.

## RESTRICTED

- gg. Service personnel must live within their means.
- hh. Subordinates must initiate compliments to their superiors and such compliments must be acknowledged.
- ii. All orders regarding saluting and other compliments must be enforced at all times both in and out of barracks.
- jj. An officer or a soldier must obtain his commanding officer's permission before getting married.
- kk. Service personnel must be punctual at all parades and other functions.
- ll. Service personnel must account for all public funds entrusted to them.
- mm. Service personnel must avoid presenting dud cheques.
- nn. Service personnel must uphold esprit-de-corps and avoid running down their units or other regiments or corps. They must neither deride the NA nor their superior officers in the presence of civilians.
- oo. Service personnel must respect family virtues and live amicably with others.
- pp. Service personnel and their families are to desist from any act by commission or omission that may make them liable for damages.
- qq. The NA recognizes only 2 religions in the barracks – Christianity (Catholic and Protestant) and Islam. All

## RESTRICTED

Service personnel are required on commission or attestation to take one of the religions but are free to change their religion if they so wish. Public worship are not permitted outside the 3 designated places of worship in the barracks.

rr. Service personnel are not to take part in the affairs of any political organization or party.

ss. All forms of political activity are prohibited in the barracks and service establishment.

tt. Service personnel are not to enter into employment of any other nation or organization without clearance from appropriate authority.

uu. Service personnel must abide by the laws of armed conflicts.

vv. In death, service personnel will be accorded full military burial except where cause of death is associated with illegal duty, cowardice, suicide or related matters.

ww. Service personnel must accord respect to persons bearing an object marked with distinctive signs, for example, Red Cross or Red Crescent and allow such persons perform their tasks unless ordered otherwise.

xx. Service personnel must protect our foreign visitors and their interests and also display high level of integrity when playing host to other nations.